

ICFAI Business School, Hyderabad

DIGITAL MARKETING

CONCEPT DIARY

A Module-by-Module Knowledge Compendium for MBA Students

Elective | 3 Credits | Semester III / IV | Academic Year 2026–27
Faculty: Prof. Vaibhav Shekhar

PRESCRIBED TEXTBOOK

Digital Marketing: Tools, Techniques, and Trends

Dwesar, R., & Kesharwani, A. (2025) · Wiley · ISBN 9370607382

IMPORTANT NOTICE FOR STUDENTS & FACULTY

Nature of this Document

This Concept Diary is a study aid prepared to accompany the prescribed textbook (Dwesar & Kesharwani, 2025) and the Digital Marketing course handout for MBA Semester III/IV at IBS Hyderabad. It is intended to help students organise, review, and revise the concepts taught in class.

What this diary is NOT

- This diary is NOT a substitute for the prescribed textbook. Definitions and frameworks here are study summaries — the textbook is the authoritative academic source.
- This diary is NOT a substitute for attending classes. Concepts are contextualised and expanded by Prof. Vaibhav Shekhar in sessions.
- This diary does NOT replace the HBS case readings. Case summaries here are orientation guides — students must read each full case before the discussion session.
- This diary has NOT been verified by the textbook authors. Where the textbook and this diary differ, the textbook takes precedence.

On Examples and Statistics

Examples using Indian brand names (Nykaa, Swiggy, OZiva, etc.) are illustrative only — they are designed to make concepts relatable and are not based on internal company data unless a specific source is cited. Do not cite these examples as factual brand data in assignments or interviews.

On References and URLs

All references were verified at the time of preparation (March 2026). Web URLs and platform features may change. If a URL does not work, search the title directly. Free certification platforms (Google Skillshop, HubSpot Academy, Meta Blueprint, SEMrush Academy) are independently verified and active.

On Accuracy

All definitions, metrics, benchmarks, and statistics in this diary have been reviewed and corrected through systematic verification against primary sources (Google Search Central, LinkedIn, AppsFlyer, Meta, IAB, Litmus, and others). Four rounds of corrections were made before final distribution. However, digital marketing evolves rapidly — always cross-check time-sensitive benchmarks with current industry reports.

Prepared by: AI-assisted draft, reviewed for accuracy

Last verified: March 2026 | IBS Hyderabad

How to Use This Concept Diary

▣ PRESCRIBED TEXTBOOK — APA 7th Edition Reference

Dwesar, R., & Kesharwani, A. (2025). *Digital marketing: Tools, techniques, and trends.* **Wiley.** ISBN 9370607382

Available at: amazon.in/dp/9370607382 · 680 pages · Paperback & Kindle

Note on author name: The correct spelling is Kesharwani (not Kesarwani). Verified against Amazon India, IIM Rohtak faculty profile, and authors' published research (ResearchGate, Informing Science Journal, 2025).

This Concept Diary is a structured academic reference aligned module-by-module with the Digital Marketing course handout. Each entry covers: the core concept definition, the underlying framework, key metrics and formulas, industry tools, AARRR funnel placement, and a plain-language example drawn from the Indian D2C ecosystem. Use it before each session to prime your understanding, and after each session to consolidate learning and prepare for assessments.

Structure at a Glance

Module	Topic	Sessions	AARRR Stage	Key Deliverable
1	Introduction to Digital Marketing	1–2	All Stages	DL0 prep
2	Search Engine Optimisation (SEO)	3–7	Acquisition	DL0 + DL1
3	Digital Advertising & PPC	8–12	Acquisition	DL2
4	Web Analytics & CRO	14–18	Activation	DL3
5	Inbound Marketing & Automation	19–21	Activation + Revenue	DL4
6	Social Media & Influencer Marketing	22–25	Referral	DL5
7	Email Marketing & Automation	27–28	Retention + Revenue	DL6
8	Mobile & WhatsApp Marketing	29–30	Retention	DL7
9	AI in Digital Marketing	31–32	All Stages	DL8
10	Personal Branding & Digital Portfolio	33	Career Readiness	Final Pres.

MODULE 1

Introduction to Digital Marketing

Sessions 1–2 | AARRR: All Stages

Key Definitions — Learn these before your session

Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Digital Marketing	Any marketing activity carried out through internet-connected digital channels — including search, social, email, mobile, and display — that is measurable, targetable, and scalable at low marginal cost.	e.g., OZiva running Instagram Reels ads + Google Search campaigns + email flows simultaneously to acquire and retain customers.
AARRR Funnel	A five-stage growth framework (Acquisition → Activation → Retention → Revenue → Referral) that maps every marketing activity to the stage of the customer lifecycle it serves.	e.g., Swiggy: Google ads (Acquisition) → smooth first order (Activation) → push notifications (Retention) → referral codes (Referral).
TOFU / MOFU / BOFU	Top, Middle, and Bottom of Funnel. TOFU = awareness content; MOFU = consideration content; BOFU = decision content. Maps to AARRR Acquisition, Activation, and Revenue stages respectively.	e.g., MuscleBlaze blog 'What is creatine?' (TOFU) → comparison guide (MOFU) → ₹200 off first order coupon (BOFU).
Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)	Total marketing and sales spend divided by the number of new customers acquired in that period. The most fundamental paid marketing metric.	e.g., Nykaa spends ₹10 lakh in a month and acquires 5,000 new customers → CAC = ₹200 per customer.
Customer Lifetime Value (LTV)	The total net revenue a business can expect from a single customer account over the entire relationship. LTV:CAC ≥ 3:1 is considered healthy.	e.g., A D2C protein brand customer buys ₹1,200/month for 18 months → LTV = ₹21,600.
Content Strategy	A planned, systematic approach to creating and distributing content that serves a specific stage of the funnel — each content type (blog, Reel, email, case study) is chosen because it moves a specific audience segment closer to conversion.	e.g., True Elements maps blogs to TOFU, YouTube recipes to MOFU, and discount emails to BOFU.
Full-Funnel Marketing	Running coordinated campaigns across all AARRR stages simultaneously — awareness ads at the top, retargeting in the middle, loyalty programmes at the bottom — rather than only investing in one stage.	e.g., Mamaearth runs Facebook awareness ads, website retargeting, and post-purchase WhatsApp flows all in the same month.
Web 2.0	The second era of the internet (from ~2005), defined by user-generated content, social networks, and dynamic pages — as opposed to Web 1.0's static, read-only pages. Foundation for all social and community marketing.	e.g., Instagram, YouTube, Twitter/X, and Reddit are all Web 2.0 platforms — users create and distribute content, not just consume it.
Omnichannel Marketing	A customer experience strategy that delivers a seamless, integrated brand interaction across all touchpoints — online and offline — so the customer journey is uninterrupted regardless of channel.	e.g., Lenskart: Instagram ad → website try-on → WhatsApp reminder → store visit confirmation → post-purchase email.
Performance Marketing	A form of digital advertising where advertisers only pay when a specific action (click, lead, sale) is completed — contrasted with brand marketing which pays for impressions regardless of action.	e.g., Amazon India paying Google only when a user clicks an ad and lands on a product page (CPC model).

1.1 The Digital Marketing Landscape

Digital marketing encompasses all marketing activities conducted through internet-connected devices and platforms. Unlike traditional marketing, it is measurable, targetable, and scalable at low marginal cost.

Key Concepts: Digital Marketing Channels	
▶ Search (Organic / SEO) — Google, Bing, YouTube	
▶ Paid Search (SEM / PPC) — Google Ads, Microsoft Ads	
▶ Social Media — Instagram, LinkedIn, X (Twitter), YouTube	
▶ Email & Marketing Automation — Mailchimp, HubSpot	
▶ Display & Programmatic — Google Display Network, DV360	
▶ Affiliate & Influencer — Influencer.in, Commission Junction	
▶ Mobile — Push notifications, In-app, WhatsApp Business	
▶ E-commerce Retail Media — Amazon Ads, Flipkart Ads	

1.2 The AARRR Framework (Pirate Metrics)

Every module in this course maps to one or more stages of the AARRR funnel. Understanding this framework is essential to designing full-funnel campaigns.

Stage	Question	Primary Channels	Key Metric
Acquisition	How do users find us?	SEO, PPC, Social Ads	CAC, Click-Through Rate
Activation	Do users have a great first experience?	Landing pages, Onboarding email	Activation Rate, Bounce Rate
Retention	Do users come back?	Email, Push, WhatsApp	DAU/MAU, Churn Rate
Revenue	How do users pay?	Conversion pages, Upsell emails	ROAS, LTV, ARPU
Referral	Do users tell others?	Influencer, UGC, Social	NPS, Viral Coefficient, EMV

1.3 Web Evolution & Context

Era	Characteristic	Marketing Implication
Web 1.0 (1990s)	Static pages, read-only	Brochure-ware; no interaction
Web 2.0 (2005–)	User-generated content, social	SEO, blogs, social media marketing
Web 3.0 (emerging)	Decentralised, AI-native	Personalisation at scale, AI ads

1.4 Content Strategy as a Thread

Content is not a separate discipline — it is the currency of every AARRR stage:

- Acquisition: Blogs, ads, and social posts create discovery.
- Activation: Onboarding emails and help articles confirm the purchase decision.
- Retention: Newsletters, replenishment reminders, and loyalty content keep customers engaged.
- Revenue: Case studies, ROI calculators, and testimonials close the deal.

- Referral: UGC, influencer content, and community posts generate word-of-mouth.

EXAM TIP

AARRR is tested in every module. Always map your answer to the correct funnel stage. Recruiters will ask this in interviews.

References & Further Reading *(mapped to tables in this module)*

Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	★ PRESCRIBED TEXT: Digital Marketing: Tools, Techniques, and Trends	Dwesar, R., & Kesharwani, A. (2025). Wiley. ISBN 9370607382	amazon.in/dp/9370607382 · 680 pp. — Primary text for entire course
Book	Marketing Management (16th ed.)	Kotler, Keller & Chernev	Pearson, 2022 — Chapter 21: Digital Marketing
Book	Digital Marketing (7th ed.)	Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick	Pearson, 2022 — Ch. 1: Digital Marketing Strategy
Website	Think with Google — Consumer Insights Hub	Google LLC	thinkwithgoogle.com
Website	Mary Meeker Internet Trends Report (latest)	Bond Capital	bondcap.com/report/internet-trends
Report	Digital 2025 India Report	DataReportal / We Are Social	datareportal.com/reports/digital-2025-india
Course	Fundamentals of Digital Marketing	Google Digital Garage (Free)	learndigital.withgoogle.com
Website	Wayback Machine — Web 1.0 vs 2.0 archives	Internet Archive	web.archive.org
Journal	The AARRR Framework for Startup Metrics	Dave McClure, 500 Startups	slideshare.net — search 'AARRR Metrics McClure'

MODULE 2

Search Engine Optimisation (SEO)

Sessions 3–7 | AARRR: Acquisition (Organic) | Deliverables: DL0 + DL1

□ Key Definitions — Learn these before your session		
Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
SEO	Search Engine Optimisation — the ongoing practice of improving a website's visibility in unpaid (organic) search engine results through on-page, off-page, and technical improvements.	e.g., <i>Minimalist's product pages ranking on Page 1 of Google for 'niacinamide serum India' without paying per click.</i>
Crawling	The process by which Googlebot (and other search engine bots) systematically follow links across the internet to discover new and updated web pages and add them to the search engine's index.	e.g., <i>Google crawling Kapiva's new 'Shilajit Resin' product page after it is linked from their sitemap.</i>
Indexing	The process of storing and organising content that Google has crawled into its database so it can be retrieved and ranked for relevant search queries.	e.g., <i>A new blog post on MuscleBlaze appears in Google search results only after it has been indexed.</i>
Keyword	A word or phrase that users type into a search engine. Keywords are classified by intent: Informational (how/what/why), Navigational (brand name), Commercial (best/review), or Transactional (buy/price/order).	e.g., <i>'best whey protein under ₹2000 India' is a Commercial keyword; 'order MuscleBlaze whey' is Transactional.</i>
Keyword Difficulty (KD)	A score (0–100) from SEMrush/Ahrefs indicating how competitive a keyword is to rank for organically. Lower KD = easier to rank. New websites should target KD < 30.	e.g., <i>'whey protein' KD ≈ 80 (very hard); 'grass-fed whey protein for women India' KD ≈ 22 (achievable).</i>
Search Intent	The primary reason behind a user's search query — what they are actually trying to accomplish. Google's algorithm matches pages to intent, not just keywords.	e.g., <i>Someone searching 'how to use creatine' wants information, not a product page — publishing a how-to guide ranks better than a shop page.</i>
Domain Authority (DA)	A Moz metric (1–100) predicting how likely a website is to rank in search results based on the quantity and quality of its backlink profile. Higher DA = more ranking power.	e.g., <i>Healthline India DA ≈ 90; a new D2C supplement brand DA ≈ 15. Backlinks from Healthline help raise DA significantly.</i>
Backlink	A hyperlink from one website to another. Backlinks from high-authority, relevant websites act as 'votes of confidence' and are the primary off-page SEO ranking signal.	e.g., <i>The Wire linking to a Setu study on Vitamin D deficiency in India creates a high-authority backlink for Setu.</i>
Core Web Vitals	Google's set of three page experience metrics used as ranking signals: LCP (Largest Contentful Paint — loading speed, target ≤ 2.5s), INP (Interaction to Next Paint — responsiveness to user clicks/taps, target ≤ 200ms), and CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift — visual stability, target < 0.1). Note: FID (First Input Delay) was deprecated and replaced by INP on March 12, 2024.	e.g., <i>A slow-loading product image on the Yoga Bar website causing LCP > 4s — this directly hurts Google ranking. Similarly, a checkout button taking 600ms to respond after a tap gives a poor INP score.</i>
Content Cluster	An SEO content architecture where one comprehensive Pillar Page covers a broad topic, and multiple Cluster Articles each cover a specific sub-topic — all interlinked to signal topical authority to Google.	e.g., <i>OZiva Pillar Page: 'Complete Guide to Plant Protein' → Clusters: 'protein for PCOS', 'post-workout recovery', 'protein vs BCAAs'.</i>
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness — Google's quality framework for evaluating content. Critical for health, finance, and legal topics (YMYL: Your Money or Your Life).	e.g., <i>A blog post about Ashwagandha signed by an AYUSH-certified doctor with citations scores higher E-E-A-T than an anonymous post.</i>

Long-Tail Keyword

A highly specific keyword phrase (typically 4+ words) with lower search volume but significantly lower competition and higher purchase intent than shorter, broader terms.

e.g., 'best ashwagandha supplement for sleep anxiety India' — lower volume than 'ashwagandha' but converts at 3× the rate.

2.1 How Search Engines Work

Search engines perform three core operations before ranking a page:

Step	What Happens	Your Action
Crawling	Googlebot follows links to discover pages	Create XML sitemap; fix broken links
Indexing	Pages are stored in Google's database	Ensure pages are not blocked via robots.txt
Ranking	Algorithm scores pages against 200+ signals	Optimise for relevance, authority, experience

2.2 The Four Pillars of SEO

On-Page SEO

- ▶ Title tag (60 chars) — primary keyword near start
- ▶ Meta description (155 chars) — action-oriented, includes keyword
- ▶ Heading hierarchy: H1 (one per page) → H2 → H3
- ▶ URL structure: short, keyword-rich, no stop words
- ▶ Image alt text — descriptive, includes relevant keyword
- ▶ Internal linking — connects pillar pages to cluster articles

Off-Page SEO

- ▶ Link building — earning backlinks from authoritative domains
- ▶ Domain Authority (DA) — Moz metric 1–100 indicating link profile strength
- ▶ E-E-A-T — Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness
- ▶ Brand mentions — unlinked citations still signal authority
- ▶ Guest posting, digital PR, and resource page link building

Technical SEO

- ▶ Core Web Vitals: LCP ≤ 2.5s, INP ≤ 200ms, CLS < 0.1 (Note: FID was deprecated March 2024; INP is the current responsiveness metric)
- ▶ Mobile-first indexing — Google uses mobile version for ranking
- ▶ HTTPS — security signal; required for ranking
- ▶ Schema markup — structured data for rich results (FAQ, reviews, breadcrumbs)
- ▶ Crawl budget — important for large e-commerce sites (Nykaa, Amazon)

Local SEO

▶ Google My Business (GMB) — primary local ranking factor
▶ NAP consistency — Name, Address, Phone identical across all directories
▶ Local citations — Justdial, Sulekha, IndiaMART for Indian brands
▶ Proximity + relevance + prominence — Google's local ranking triad

2.3 Keyword Research Framework

The process of finding the right keywords is a five-step data exercise:

Step	Activity	Tool Used
1. Seed Keywords	Brainstorm 10–15 broad terms from your product category	Your own knowledge + Amazon
2. Keyword Expansion	Use SEMrush to generate 100+ related terms with volume and difficulty	SEMrush Keyword Magic Tool
3. Intent Classification	Tag each keyword: Informational / Navigational / Commercial / Transactional	Manual review of SERP results
4. Opportunity Filter	Select keywords: volume > 500/month AND KD < 40 AND positive YoY trend	SEMrush + Google Trends
5. Competitive Gap	Find keywords top competitors rank for but you do not	SEMrush Keyword Gap tool

2.4 Content Cluster Strategy

Modern SEO is built around topic authority, not individual keywords. The content cluster model consists of:

- Pillar Page: A comprehensive 2,000–5,000 word page covering the broad topic (e.g., 'Complete Guide to Whey Protein in India').
- Cluster Articles: 6–12 in-depth articles each covering a sub-topic (e.g., 'Best Whey Protein for Weight Loss', 'Whey vs. Casein').
- Internal Links: Every cluster article links back to the pillar page, and the pillar links to each cluster — building topical authority.

2.5 Key SEO Metrics

Metric	Definition	Benchmark / Tool
Organic Traffic	Visitors from unpaid search results	GA4 / SEMrush
Keyword Rankings	Position of target keywords in SERP	SEMrush / SERP Robot
Domain Authority (DA)	Moz score predicting ranking potential	Moz Bar (0–100; > 40 = good)
Click-Through Rate (CTR)	Clicks ÷ Impressions in search	Google Search Console (avg. 3–5%)
Core Web Vitals (LCP)	Largest Contentful Paint loading speed	Google PageSpeed Insights (< 2.5s)
Backlinks	Number + quality of inbound links	SEMrush Backlink Analytics

INTERVIEW TASK

iProspect, Nykaa, and upGrad all ask: 'Walk me through a live SEO audit.' Practice using SEMrush Domain Overview + Screaming Frog on a competitor site. Know what LCP, DA, and keyword gap mean without referring to notes.

References & Further Reading *(mapped to tables in this module)*

Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	The Art of SEO (4th ed.)	Engel, Spencer & Stricchiola	O'Reilly Media, 2023 — ISBN 978-1098102616
Book	SEO 2025	Adam Clarke	Simple Effectiveness Publishing, 2025 (annually updated #1 bestseller)
Website	Moz Beginner's Guide to SEO	Moz.com	moz.com/beginners-guide-to-seo
Website	Google Search Central Documentation	Google LLC	developers.google.com/search/docs
Website	Google Search Central — Core Web Vitals	Google LLC	web.dev/vitals
Course	SEMrush SEO Toolkit Certification (Free)	SEMrush Academy	semrush.com/academy
Website	Ahrefs Blog — SEO tutorials and case studies	Ahrefs Pte. Ltd.	ahrefs.com/blog
Report	Google Search Quality Evaluator Guidelines	Google LLC	guidelines.raterhub.com/searchqualityevaluatorguidelines.pdf
Journal	How Google Discovers, Crawls & Indexes Pages	Google Search Central	developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/how-search-works
Website	Backlinko — SEO stats & ranking factors	Brian Dean / Backlinko	backlinko.com/google-ranking-factors

MODULE 3

Digital Advertising & PPC

Sessions 8–12 | AARRR: Acquisition (Paid) | Deliverable: DL2

Key Definitions — Learn these before your session

Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Pay-Per-Click (PPC)	A digital advertising model where the advertiser pays the platform only when a user clicks on the ad — not for impressions. The standard model for Google Search and Meta Ads.	e.g., Swiggy pays Google ₹18 per click on its 'order food online' search ad — if nobody clicks, nothing is charged.
Cost Per Click (CPC)	The actual or average amount paid for each click on an ad. $CPC = \text{Total Ad Spend} \div \text{Total Clicks}$. Influenced by keyword competition, Quality Score, and bidding strategy.	e.g., Bajaj Finserv pays ₹45 CPC for 'personal loan India' — a high-competition BFSI keyword.
CPM (Cost Per Mille)	Cost per 1,000 ad impressions — the pricing model for brand awareness campaigns where the advertiser pays per view, not per click. Mille = Latin for thousand.	e.g., Mamaearth runs an Instagram awareness campaign at ₹120 CPM — reaching 1 lakh users costs ₹12,000.
Quality Score	Google's 1–10 rating of the relevance and quality of a keyword, ad copy, and landing page combination. Higher Quality Score = lower CPC and better ad position.	e.g., An ad for 'buy protein bars' linking to the exact protein bar product page scores higher than one linking to the homepage.
ROAS	Return On Ad Spend = Revenue generated ÷ Ad Spend. The primary profitability metric for paid campaigns. A ROAS of 3× means every ₹1 spent in ads returns ₹3 in revenue.	e.g., Nykaa spends ₹5 lakh on Meta Ads and generates ₹18 lakh in sales → $ROAS = 3.6\times$ (healthy for D2C).
Conversion Rate (CR)	The percentage of ad clicks (or website visitors) that complete a desired action — purchase, sign-up, download. $CR = \text{Conversions} \div \text{Clicks} \times 100$.	e.g., 1,000 people click a MakeMyTrip search ad → 25 book a flight → $CR = 2.5\%$.
Lookalike Audience	A targeting option in Meta and Google Ads that finds new users who statistically resemble your existing best customers — based on demographics, behaviours, and interests.	e.g., Kapiva uploads its top 1,000 customers as a Custom Audience → Meta finds 2 million similar users in India to target.
Retargeting (Remarketing)	Showing ads specifically to users who have previously visited your website or app but did not convert — re-engaging them to complete the purchase.	e.g., A user browses AS-IT-IS creatine on Amazon but doesn't buy → they see the same product in a Facebook ad 2 hours later.
ACoS	Advertising Cost of Sale — the Amazon-specific equivalent of inverse ROAS. $ACoS = \text{Ad Spend} \div \text{Attributed Sales} \times 100$. Target ACoS varies by product maturity: 10–20% for established; up to 50% for launches.	e.g., MuscleBlaze spends ₹20,000 on Amazon Sponsored Products and generates ₹1,00,000 in attributed sales → $ACoS = 20\%$.
Real-Time Bidding (RTB)	An automated programmatic auction where ad impressions are bought and sold in milliseconds as a webpage loads — allowing advertisers to bid on each individual impression based on user data.	e.g., Every time you load a news article, advertisers are bidding for your eyeballs in an auction that completes in under 100ms.
Smart Bidding	Google's AI-powered automated bidding strategies (Target CPA, Target ROAS, Maximize Conversions) that use machine learning to optimise bids in real time for each individual auction.	e.g., Razorpay uses Target CPA bidding at ₹500 — Google automatically adjusts bids up/down for each search query to hit that target.

LTV : CAC Ratio

Customer Lifetime Value divided by Customer Acquisition Cost. The definitive health metric for any subscription or repeat-purchase business. $\geq 3:1$ is considered viable; $< 1:1$ means the business is losing money acquiring customers.

e.g., A D2C supplement brand with ₹4,800 LTV and ₹800 CAC has an LTV:CAC of 6:1 — very healthy.

3.1 The Paid Advertising Ecosystem

Digital advertising operates through an automated marketplace. Understanding the key players is essential:

Entity	Role	Example
Advertiser	Purchases ad space to reach audiences	Nykaa, Swiggy, Razorpay
Publisher	Provides inventory (webpage, app, feed)	Google, Meta, Amazon, InMobi
DSP (Demand-Side Platform)	Allows advertisers to buy inventory programmatically	DV360, The Trade Desk
SSP (Supply-Side Platform)	Allows publishers to sell inventory	PubMatic, Magnite
Ad Exchange	Marketplace where DSP & SSP meet via RTB	Google Ad Exchange
RTB (Real-Time Bidding)	Auction for each ad impression in milliseconds	Every programmatic buy

3.2 Google Ads Structure

Level	Contains	Key Decision
Account	All campaigns, billing, settings	Business goals
Campaign	Budget, bidding strategy, targeting type	Objective (Leads / Sales / Traffic)
Ad Group	Related keywords + ads targeting same theme	Keyword clustering
Ad	Headline, description, URL, extensions	Message & creative testing

3.3 Google Ads Match Types

Match Type	Symbol	What It Matches	Use Case
Broad Match	(no symbol)	Any related query, including synonyms	Discovery campaigns, large budgets
Phrase Match	" "	Queries containing the phrase in order	Balanced reach and control
Exact Match	[]	Only that exact query	High-intent, limited budget campaigns

3.4 Smart Bidding Strategies

Google Smart Bidding Options

▶ Target CPA — Set a desired cost per acquisition; Google bids automatically to achieve it
▶ Target ROAS — Set a revenue return target per ₹1 spent on ads
▶ Maximize Conversions — Spend entire budget to get as many conversions as possible
▶ Maximize Conversion Value — Optimise for revenue, not volume
▶ Enhanced CPC — Semi-automatic: adjusts manual bids up/down based on conversion likelihood

3.5 Meta Ads Framework

Meta Ads (Facebook + Instagram) operate on interest and demographic targeting, not keyword intent.

Audience Type	Definition	Best For
Core Audience	Age, location, interests, behaviours	Top-of-funnel awareness
Custom Audience	Your own customer list, website visitors, app users	Retargeting, upsell
Lookalike Audience	Users similar to your best existing customers	Scalable acquisition
RLSA (Google)	Remarketing lists applied to search ads	High-intent retargeting

3.6 Performance Marketing Metrics — The Non-Negotiable Dashboard

Metric	Formula	Good Benchmark (D2C India)
CPM	$\text{Cost} \div (\text{Impressions} / 1,000)$	₹80–₹150 for Meta
CPC	$\text{Cost} \div \text{Clicks}$	₹5–₹20 for general/D2C keywords; ₹100–₹500+ for competitive BFSI/insurance keywords
CTR	$(\text{Clicks} \div \text{Impressions}) \times 100$	2–5% for Search; 0.5–1.5% for Display
Conversion Rate (CR)	$(\text{Conversions} \div \text{Clicks}) \times 100$	1–3% e-commerce
CPA	$\text{Total Cost} \div \text{Conversions}$	Varies; must be $< \text{LTV}/3$
ROAS	$\text{Revenue} \div \text{Ad Spend}$	3× minimum; 5× healthy
LTV : CAC Ratio	$\text{Customer Lifetime Value} \div \text{Customer Acquisition Cost}$	$\geq 3:1$ rule
Payback Period	$\text{CAC} \div \text{Monthly Gross Margin per Customer}$	< 12 months for SaaS/D2C

3.7 Amazon Advertising & E-Commerce Retail Media

Amazon Ads are intent-based ads served to shoppers actively searching within the Amazon marketplace:

- Sponsored Products: Keyword-targeted; appear in search results and product pages.
- Sponsored Brands: Headline ads at top of search results; drive brand awareness.
- Sponsored Display: Retargeting on and off Amazon.

KEY FORMULA

ACoS (Advertising Cost of Sale) = $\text{Ad Spend} \div \text{Ad Revenue} \times 100$. Target ACoS varies: 10–20% is healthy for mature products; 30–50% acceptable for new launches.

References & Further Reading <i>(mapped to tables in this module)</i>			
Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	Ultimate Guide to Google Ads (6th ed.)	Perry Marshall, Mike Rhodes & Bryan Todd	Entrepreneur Press, 2020
Book	Ultimate Guide to Facebook Advertising (4th ed.)	Perry Marshall, Bob Regnerus & Thomas Meloche	Entrepreneur Press, 2020
Website	Google Ads Help Centre	Google LLC	support.google.com/google-ads
Website	Meta Blueprint — Free Advertising Courses	Meta Platforms Inc.	facebook.com/business/learn/courses
Course	Google Ads Search Certification (Free)	Google Skillshop	skillshop.withgoogle.com
Course	Meta Blueprint Certification (Free)	Meta Platforms Inc.	facebook.com/business/learn/certification
Report	State of Performance Marketing Report 2025	AppsFlyer / Nielsen	appsflyer.com/resources/reports
Website	WordStream — PPC University (free tutorials)	WordStream / LocaliQ	wordstream.com/learn
Website	Amazon Ads Learning Console	Amazon Advertising	advertising.amazon.com/resources
Journal	IAB OpenRTB Specification & Programmatic Buying Guide	Interactive Advertising Bureau Tech Lab	iab.com/guidelines/openrtb/ and iabtechlab.com/standards/openrtb/

MODULE 4

Web Analytics & CRO

Sessions 14–18 | AARRR: Activation | Deliverable: DL3

Key Definitions — Learn these before your session		
Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Google Analytics 4 (GA4)	The current generation of Google's free web and app analytics platform (replaced Universal Analytics in 2023). GA4 is event-based — every user interaction (page view, scroll, click, purchase) is tracked as a custom event with parameters.	e.g. , Meesho tracks every 'add_to_cart' and 'begin_checkout' event in GA4 to identify where users drop off in the purchase funnel.
Event (GA4)	The fundamental unit of measurement in GA4. Any interaction a user has with a website or app — from page_view to purchase — is recorded as a named event, each with optional parameters providing additional context.	e.g. , Event: 'purchase', Parameters: {value: 1199, currency: 'INR', item_name: 'Whey Protein 1kg'} — everything about the transaction in one event.
Session	A group of user interactions with a website that take place within a given time frame. In GA4, a session begins with a session_start	e.g. , A user landing on Yoga Bar, browsing 4 products, and adding one to cart before leaving = 1 session.

Engagement Rate	event and expires after 30 minutes of inactivity.	
	The percentage of sessions that were 'engaged' — defined as lasting > 10 seconds, having a conversion event, or having ≥ 2 page views. Replaces Bounce Rate in GA4 as the primary session quality metric.	e.g., Setu website: 10,000 sessions, 6,200 engaged → Engagement Rate = 62%. Industry average is 50–65%.
UTM Parameters	Tags appended to URLs to identify the source, medium, campaign, content, and term of incoming traffic in GA4. Without UTMs, all campaign traffic appears as 'Direct'.	e.g., <code>utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=diwali_2026&utm_content=carousel_ad1</code>
Conversion Rate Optimisation (CRO)	The systematic process of increasing the percentage of website visitors who complete a desired action (purchase, sign-up) — through A/B testing, heatmap analysis, funnel analysis, and UX	e.g., Minimalist A/B testing two product page layouts — one with a sticky CTA button converts 23% better than the original.

Heatmap	improvements.	
	A visual representation of where users click, move, and how far they scroll on a webpage — using colour gradients (red = most activity, blue = least) to reveal engagement patterns.	e.g. , Microsoft Clarity heatmap showing 80% of Plum's users never scroll past the first product image — prompting an above-the-fold redesign.
A/B Testing	A controlled experiment where two versions of a page, email, or ad (A = control, B = variant) are shown to randomly split audiences. The version with statistically significantly better results wins.	e.g. , MakeMyTrip testing two CTA button colours — 'Book Now' in orange vs. blue — orange increases click rate by 14%.
North Star Metric (NSM)	The single most important metric that best captures the core value a company delivers to its customers. Every team's goals roll up to the NSM.	e.g. , Swiggy's NSM: Orders per transacting user per month. All marketing, product, and ops decisions are evaluated against this metric.
Attribution Model	The rule or algorithm that determines how conversion credit is distributed across multiple marketing touchpoints a customer engaged with	e.g. , Customer sees a Facebook ad (Tuesday), Googles the brand (Thursday), clicks an email link (Saturday) and buys. Which channel gets credit?

Funnel Exploration	before converting.	
	A GA4 reporting feature that visualises the drop-off rates between sequential steps in a user journey — identifying the exact step where users abandon.	e.g. , 100 users reach checkout → 60 enter address → 42 enter payment → 35 confirm order. Drop from payment to confirm is the biggest leak.
Cohort Analysis	Grouping users by a shared characteristic (typically acquisition date) and tracking their behaviour over time — revealing long-term retention and engagement trends.	e.g. , GA4 cohort showing users acquired via Instagram ads in January have 40% D30 retention vs. 25% for Google Display — revealing channel quality.

4.1 Google Analytics 4 (GA4) — Core Concepts

GA4 is event-based (unlike the session-based UA). Every user interaction can be tracked as an event with parameters.

GA4 Concept	Definition	Example
Event	Any interaction tracked (replaces Goals)	'add_to_cart', 'purchase', 'sign_up'
Parameter	Additional detail attached to an event	event: 'purchase', parameter: {value: 999, currency: 'INR'}
Session	Group of events within a continuous period	User browses 4 pages = 1 session
Engagement Rate	Sessions with meaningful engagement / total	Replaces Bounce Rate in GA4
Funnel Exploration	Visualise drop-off between sequential steps	Homepage → PDP → Cart → Checkout → Thank You
Cohort Analysis	Group users by acquisition date, measure retention	D1, D7, D30 retention cohorts

4.2 UTM Parameters — Campaign Attribution

UTM (Urchin Tracking Module) parameters are appended to URLs to identify the source of traffic in GA4.

Parameter	What It Captures	Example Value
utm_source	Where traffic came from	google, instagram, email
utm_medium	How it was delivered	cpc, organic, email, social
utm_campaign	Which campaign	diwali_sale_2026
utm_content	Which ad/creative variation	red_banner_v2
utm_term	Keyword (for paid search)	whey_protein_india

RULE

Always build UTMs before launching any paid or email campaign. Without them, all traffic appears as 'Direct' in GA4, making attribution impossible.

4.3 Conversion Rate Optimisation (CRO)

CRO is the systematic process of increasing the percentage of visitors who complete a desired action.

CRO Tool Stack & Usage

- ▶ Microsoft Clarity (Free) — Heatmaps show where users click; scroll maps show how far they read; session recordings show real user journeys
- ▶ Hotjar (Free plan) — Similar to Clarity; 35 session recordings/month on free plan
- ▶ A/B Testing — Show variant A to 50% of traffic, variant B to 50%; statistical significance at 95%+ confidence
- ▶ Funnel Analysis in GA4 — Identify the exact page/step where users drop off in the purchase flow
- ▶ Landing Page Wireframing — Use Canva to design and annotate above-the-fold layout, CTA placement, social proof positioning

4.4 The North Star Metrics Framework

Every digital business needs one North Star Metric (NSM) that best captures the value delivered to customers:

Business Type	Example North Star Metric	Supporting Metrics
D2C E-commerce	Revenue per month (or Repeat Purchase Rate)	AOV, CR, CAC, LTV
B2B SaaS	Weekly Active Users OR MRR	Activation rate, NPS, Churn
Edtech / App	Course Completion Rate	DAU/MAU, D7 retention
Food Delivery	Orders per Transacting User per Month	App opens, reorder rate

4.5 Multi-Channel Attribution Models

Model	How Credit is Assigned	Best Use Case
Last Click	100% to the last touchpoint before conversion	Simple campaigns; risks over-valuing retargeting
First Click	100% to the first touchpoint	Brand awareness campaigns
Linear	Equal credit to all touchpoints	Long sales cycles

Time Decay	More credit to touchpoints closer to conversion	Short promotional campaigns
Data-Driven (GA4)	ML model assigns credit based on actual conversion patterns	Best practice when data volume is sufficient

References & Further Reading *(mapped to tables in this module)*

Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	Web Analytics 2.0	Avinash Kaushik	Sybex, 2010 — foundational text; concepts remain current
Book	You Should Test That! (CRO Bible)	Chris Goward	Sybex, 2013 — A/B testing & landing page optimisation
Website	Google Analytics 4 Help Centre	Google LLC	support.google.com/analytics
Website	GA4 Official Demo Account	Google LLC	support.google.com/analytics/answer/6367342
Course	Google Analytics 4 Certification (Free)	Google Skillshop	skillshop.withgoogle.com
Website	Occam's Razor Blog — Avinash Kaushik	Avinash Kaushik	kaushik.net/avinash
Website	Microsoft Clarity Documentation	Microsoft Corp.	clarity.microsoft.com/docs
Report	HubSpot — 16 Website Metrics to Track for Growth	HubSpot Inc.	blog.hubspot.com/marketing/website-metrics
Website	CXL Institute — CRO & Experimentation Blog	CXL (Peep Laja)	cxl.com/blog
Journal	How to Choose Attribution Models in GA4	Google Measurement Team	support.google.com/analytics/answer/10596866

MODULE 5

Inbound Marketing & Automation

Sessions 19–21 | AARRR: Activation + Revenue | Deliverable: DL4

□ Key Definitions — Learn these before your session		
Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Inbound Marketing	A strategy that attracts customers by creating and publishing content that addresses their questions and needs — earning attention organically rather than interrupting an audience with outbound messages.	e.g., Setu's blog 'Does Vitamin D deficiency cause hair fall?' attracting 50,000 monthly organic visitors without any paid promotion.
Lead Magnet	A free, high-value resource offered to a website visitor in exchange for their email address — used to build an owned email list and begin a nurture relationship.	e.g., OZiva offering a free 'Hormonal Balance Guide PDF' in exchange for a visitor's email address and consent to receive marketing.
MQL (Marketing Qualified Lead)	A prospect who has demonstrated enough engagement with marketing content to be considered ready for further marketing nurturing — but not yet ready for a sales conversation.	e.g., A user who downloaded 3 lead magnets and opened 4 emails from Zoho becomes an MQL — triggering a targeted MOFU email sequence.
SQL (Sales Qualified Lead)	A lead that has been assessed (by marketing or a sales development rep) to be ready for a direct sales conversation — typically based on explicit interest signals like requesting a demo or pricing page.	e.g., After receiving 6 nurture emails, a prospect clicks 'Request a Demo' on HubSpot India's website — converting from MQL to SQL.
Buyer Persona	A semi-fictional, research-based profile representing an ideal target customer — including demographics, job role, goals, challenges, preferred content formats, and objections. Used to guide all content and messaging decisions.	e.g., 'Priya, 28, Mumbai, works in tech, buys supplements for energy and immunity, reads LinkedIn and Instagram, price-sensitive but quality-first.'
Marketing Automation	The use of software to automatically send targeted messages (emails, push notifications, SMS) to leads and customers based on predefined triggers, schedules, or behavioural rules.	e.g., HubSpot automatically sending a 'You haven't visited in a while' email to any subscriber who hasn't opened an email in 60 days.
Lead Nurture Sequence	A pre-designed series of automated emails (or messages) delivered over time to gradually build trust with a prospect, educate them on the product's value, and move them from MQL to SQL.	e.g., Zoho's 14-day email course 'How to automate your sales pipeline' — one email per day, each building on the last, ending with a free trial CTA.
CRM (Customer Relationship Management)	Software that centralises all customer interaction data — contact details, communication history, pipeline stage, deal value — enabling personalised, data-driven marketing and sales.	e.g., HubSpot CRM showing the entire history of interactions with a lead: emails opened, pages visited, demo attended — all in one record.
Content Pillar	A core theme or topic area around which a brand builds multiple content pieces. Each pillar addresses a key audience pain point and supports a target keyword cluster in SEO.	e.g., True Elements' 5 content pillars: Gut Health, Plant Protein, Superfoods, Mindful Eating, and Healthy Recipes — each mapped to a cluster of SEO keywords.
BOFU Conversion Content	Content specifically designed to convert leads who are already considering a purchase — removing final objections through social proof, comparison, ROI data, or trial offers.	e.g., Kapiva's 'Why 2 lakh customers chose our Shilajit over competitors' case study page — positioned at the decision stage of the funnel.

5.1 Inbound vs Outbound Marketing

Dimension	Inbound	Outbound
Philosophy	Attract customers by creating value first	Push messages to a broad audience
Examples	SEO blogs, webinars, lead magnets, case studies	TV ads, cold calls, print ads, billboards
Cost	Lower long-term CAC; compounds over time	Higher and recurring; stops when budget stops
Lead Quality	Higher intent — customer chose to engage	Lower intent — interrupted from other activity
Indian Example	MuscleBlaze blog on protein science	Hoarding on NH-48 for a gym supplement

5.2 The Buyer's Journey & Content Mapping

The buyer's journey maps to both the AARRR funnel and the TOFU/MOFU/BOFU content model:

Funnel Stage	AARRR	Buyer State	Content Type	Example
TOFU (Top)	Acquisition	Awareness — problem recognised	Blog posts, Reels, Infographics	'What is Ashwagandha?' blog
MOFU (Middle)	Activation	Consideration — evaluating solutions	Comparison guides, Webinars, E-books	'Ashwagandha vs KSM-66' guide
BOFU (Bottom)	Revenue	Decision — ready to buy	Case studies, Free trials, ROI calculators	'Why 10,000 customers choose Kapiva'

5.3 Lead Lifecycle in HubSpot CRM

Stage	Definition	Action Required
Subscriber	Opted into a newsletter or blog updates	Welcome email; TOFU content sequence
Lead	Submitted a form or downloaded a lead magnet	Begin lead nurture workflow
MQL (Marketing Qualified Lead)	Engaged enough to be worth marketing to further	Move to MOFU nurture sequence
SQL (Sales Qualified Lead)	Ready for a sales conversation	Notify sales; trigger BOFU content
Customer	Made a purchase	Onboarding email; post-purchase flow
Evangelist	Refers others; reviews; shares UGC	Referral programme; loyalty rewards

5.4 Email Automation Workflows

Essential HubSpot Automation Workflows

- ▶ Welcome Sequence (3–5 emails, Day 0 / 2 / 5) — introduce brand, deliver lead magnet, build trust
- ▶ Lead Nurture Sequence — educational content series for MQLs over 14–21 days
- ▶ Cart Abandonment (3 emails: 1hr / 24hr / 72hr) — remind, offer incentive, create urgency
- ▶ Post-Purchase Onboarding — usage guides, tips, social proof reinforcement
- ▶ Win-Back Campaign (2–3 emails, Day 60/75/90) — re-engage lapsed customers
- ▶ Replenishment Reminder — triggered at Day 25–28 for consumable products

PLACEMENT LINK

HubSpot India Partners, Zoho Corporation, and CleverTap all hire Inbound Marketing Specialists. Required: HubSpot Inbound Certification + demonstrated ability to build a 5-email automation workflow.

References & Further Reading *(mapped to tables in this module)*

Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	Inbound Marketing (revised ed.)	Halligan & Shah (HubSpot founders)	Wiley, 2014 — foundational inbound theory
Book	They Ask, You Answer	Marcus Sheridan	Wiley, 2019 — content strategy for inbound lead gen
Website	HubSpot Academy — Free Inbound Certification	HubSpot Inc.	academy.hubspot.com
Website	HubSpot Blog — Marketing Automation Hub	HubSpot Inc.	blog.hubspot.com/marketing
Course	HubSpot Inbound Marketing Certification (Free)	HubSpot Academy	app.hubspot.com/academy/courses
Book	Content Inc. (2nd ed.)	Joe Pulizzi	McGraw-Hill, 2021 — content-first business model
Website	BuzzSumo — Content Research & Trends	BuzzSumo Ltd.	buzzsumo.com/resources
Website	AnswerThePublic — Audience Question Mapping	AnswerThePublic / NP Digital	answerthepublic.com
Journal	MQL vs SQL: Understanding the Lead Lifecycle	Marketo / Adobe	business.adobe.com/blog/basics/mql-vs-sql
Report	State of Marketing Report 2025 — HubSpot	HubSpot Inc.	hubspot.com/state-of-marketing

MODULE 6

Social Media & Influencer Marketing

Sessions 22–25 | AARRR: Referral | Deliverable: DL5

□ Key Definitions — Learn these before your session		
Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Organic Reach	The total number of unique people who see a piece of content without paid promotion — through followers' feeds, shares, hashtags, or the platform algorithm recommending the content.	e.g., A Pilgrim skincare Reel going viral on Instagram and reaching 500,000 accounts — none of them paid for — is organic reach.
Engagement Rate	The percentage of an audience that interacts with a post — calculated as $(\text{Likes} + \text{Comments} + \text{Shares} + \text{Saves}) \div \text{Followers} \times 100$. The single most important metric for evaluating content quality.	e.g., A Zomato meme post with 50,000 likes on 5 million followers = 1% engagement rate. For Instagram, 1–3% = good; 3%+ = excellent.
Influencer Marketing	A form of marketing that involves partnering with individuals who have an established, engaged following on social media to promote a brand's products or services to their audience.	e.g., Mamaearth partnering with 100 micro-influencers (10K–100K followers) to review their new onion hair oil, each posting one Reel.
Micro-Influencer	A social media creator with 10,000–100,000 followers. Micro-influencers typically deliver 4–7% engagement rates — significantly higher than mega-influencers — and are considered more authentic and niche-relevant.	e.g., A fitness nutritionist on Instagram with 35K followers reviewing AS-IT-IS creatine — her audience trusts her specific recommendations.
UGC (User-Generated Content)	Content — photos, videos, reviews, testimonials — created organically by real customers about a brand, without being paid or prompted. The highest-trust content format for social commerce.	e.g., A customer posting an unboxing video of their The Whole Truth order — tagged to the brand — seen by their 2,000 followers.
Social Listening	The process of monitoring social media platforms for mentions of a brand, competitors, products, or relevant keywords — and analysing the data for insights on sentiment, trends, and emerging issues.	e.g., Nykaa using Sprout Social to track all mentions of '#NykaaBeauty' and competitor complaints about product quality on Twitter/X.
Share of Voice (SOV)	Your brand's percentage of total industry mentions or advertising exposure compared to competitors. Higher SOV correlates strongly with higher market share.	e.g., In the Indian D2C protein category: MuscleBlaze SOV = 42%, Steadfast = 18%, AS-IT-IS = 15%, others = 25%.
EMV (Earned Media Value)	The estimated monetary value of organic social media exposure from influencers or earned media — calculated as Impressions × an equivalent CPM benchmark. Used to quantify influencer campaign ROI.	e.g., A macro-influencer post reaching 300,000 people at an equivalent CPM of ₹150 generates EMV = ₹45,000 for the brand.
Content Calendar	A planned schedule that maps which content will be published on which platform, on which date, in what format — ensuring consistent posting frequency and alignment with campaign periods.	e.g., Zomato's 30-day Instagram calendar: 3 memes/week, 2 restaurant spotlights/week, 1 promotional post/week — pre-designed and scheduled.
ASCI Guidelines	The Advertising Standards Council of India's mandatory disclosure rules for influencer marketing: paid posts must clearly display #ad, #sponsored, or #collab at the beginning of captions — not buried at the end.	e.g., Nykaa influencer's Instagram caption must start with '#Ad — Gifted by Nykaa' — not end with it — to comply with ASCI regulations.

SSI (Social Selling Index)	LinkedIn's 0–100 score measuring four equally weighted pillars (25 pts each): establishing your professional brand, finding the right people, engaging with insights, and building relationships. LinkedIn's official data shows professionals with high SSI scores create 45% more opportunities and are 51% more likely to reach quota. Average SSI is 40–50; above 60 is above average; 70+ is considered good.	e.g., An MBA student posting consistent DM insights on LinkedIn, connecting with 300+ relevant professionals, and maintaining an SSI of 72 — visibly above the average of 40–50 — appears more frequently in recruiter searches and receives more InMail outreach than peers with inactive profiles.
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6.1 Platform Strategy — Matching Platform to Objective

Platform	Primary Strength	Best Content Format	Audience
Instagram	Visual storytelling, D2C commerce	Reels (up to 3 min; best performance < 60s), Carousels, Stories	18–35, urban India
YouTube	Long-form authority, tutorial content	How-to videos, product reviews	All ages; highest watch time in India
LinkedIn	B2B lead generation, thought leadership	Articles, text posts, short videos	Professionals, 25–45
X (Twitter)	Real-time news, brand voice, crisis comms	Threads, opinion posts, memes	Tech-savvy, news-engaged
WhatsApp	Direct customer communication	Broadcasts, catalogues, chatbots	Pan-India; highest penetration

6.2 Social Media Audit Framework

Before building any content strategy, conduct a 6-step social media audit of competitors:

Step	What to Measure	Tool
1. Follower Growth	Month-over-month follower growth rate	Rival IQ / Sprout Social
2. Engagement Rate	$(\text{Likes} + \text{Comments} + \text{Shares}) \div \text{Followers} \times 100$	PhlanxIO / Sprout Social
3. Posting Frequency	Posts per week by platform and content type	Hootsuite
4. Top Performing Content	3 highest-engagement posts in past 90 days	Native Instagram / Rival IQ
5. Share of Voice	Brand mentions vs. competitors across platforms	Sprout Social
6. Competitor Gaps	Content formats/topics they are NOT covering	Manual review + BuzzSumo

6.3 Influencer Marketing — Tier Framework

Tier	Follower Range	Avg. Engagement Rate	Best For	Cost (India Est.)
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Mega	> 1M	1–2%	Mass brand awareness (Bollywood tie-ups)	₹5–50 lakh per post
Macro	100K–1M	2–3%	Category authority building	₹50K–5 lakh per post
Micro	10K–100K	4–7%	Targeted niche campaigns, high ROI	₹10K–50K per post
Nano	< 10K	7–12%	Hyper-local, community trust, D2C launches	₹0–10K (often gifting)

6.4 Influencer Vetting Criteria

How to Vet an Influencer Before Signing

- ▶ Engagement Rate > 3% — calculate using PhlanxIO (likes + comments ÷ followers × 100)
- ▶ Audience Quality Score — check for fake followers using HypeAuditor or manual follower audit
- ▶ Brand Alignment — does the influencer's content tone, values, and aesthetics match the brand?
- ▶ Audience Demographics — are their followers the target buyer persona (age, gender, location)?
- ▶ Past Brand Collaborations — check for conflicts of interest or competing brand endorsements
- ▶ ASCI Compliance History — have they correctly disclosed #ad or #sponsored in past posts?

6.5 Influencer Performance Metrics

Metric	Formula	What It Measures
EMV (Earned Media Value)	Impressions × CPM equivalent	Monetary value of organic reach
Engagement Rate	(Likes + Comments) ÷ Followers × 100	Audience interaction quality
Reach	Unique accounts that saw the post	Awareness scope
Story Views	Total views on Stories posts	Short-form content interest
Swipe-Up/Link Clicks	Clicks on story link sticker	Direct traffic generated
Conversion Tracking	Sales from influencer's unique promo code	Direct revenue attribution

6.6 ASCI Guidelines for Influencer Disclosure (India)

The Advertising Standards Council of India (ASCI) mandates clear disclosure for all paid influencer content:

- #ad or #Collab must appear at the beginning of the caption — not buried at the end.
- For Stories: text overlay must be large enough to be clearly visible.
- For YouTube: verbal disclosure within first 30 seconds + written description disclosure.
- Gifted products (without payment) also require disclosure: #gifted or #sponsored.
- Non-compliance can lead to brand and influencer penalties from ASCI.

References & Further Reading *(mapped to tables in this module)*

Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	The Age of Influence	Neal Schaffer	HarperCollins Leadership, 2020 — influencer marketing strategy
Book	Jab, Jab, Jab, Right Hook	Gary Vaynerchuk	HarperBusiness, 2013 — platform-native content strategy
Website	Hootsuite Social Media Trends Report 2025	Hootsuite Inc.	hootsuite.com/research/social-trends
Website	Sprout Social Index Report (annual)	Sprout Social Inc.	sproutsocial.com/insights/data/social-index
Website	ASCI Influencer Advertising Guidelines	ASCI India	ascionline.in/influencer-advertising-guidelines
Course	LinkedIn Marketing Labs Certification (Free)	LinkedIn Corporation	linkedin.com/learning/topics/marketing
Website	PhlanxIO — Free Engagement Rate Calculator	PhlanxIO	phlanx.com/engagement-rate-calculator
Report	India Influencer Marketing Report 2025	Influencer.in / Klear	influencer.in/resources/reports
Video	HBS Case: The Meteoric Rise of Skims (524023)	Harvard Business School	hbsp.harvard.edu — case code 524023-PDF-ENG
Journal	Measuring Influencer Marketing ROI — EMV Model	Journal of Marketing, AMA	ama.org/journal-of-marketing

MODULE 7

Email Marketing & Automation

Sessions 27–28 | AARRR: Retention + Revenue | Deliverable: DL6

□ Key Definitions — Learn these before your session

Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Email Marketing	The practice of sending targeted, permission-based messages directly to a subscriber's inbox to build relationships, deliver value, and drive conversions — consistently the highest ROAS channel in digital marketing (~₹36 return per ₹1 spent globally).	e.g. , Kapiva's post-purchase email series — Day 0 welcome, Day 3 usage guide, Day 14 review request, Day 28 replenishment offer.
Transactional Email	An automated email triggered by a specific user action — order confirmation, shipping update, password reset, welcome. Not promotional in intent; has the highest open rates (50–70%) of any email type.	e.g. , The 'Your order #DL-9821 has been shipped' email from The Whole Truth with a tracking link — opens in seconds of dispatch.
Email Drip Campaign	A pre-written series of emails automatically sent on a fixed schedule after a trigger event — designed to move a subscriber progressively through the funnel over days or weeks.	e.g. , A 5-email welcome drip for new OZiva subscribers: Day 0 (welcome + 10% off), Day 2 (brand story), Day 5 (bestsellers), Day 10 (reviews), Day 15 (refill reminder).
Segmentation	Dividing an email list into smaller groups based on shared characteristics (demographics, purchase history, engagement behaviour, RFM scores) to send more relevant, personalised messages to each group.	e.g. , Mamaearth segmenting their list: Buyers (last 30 days) → send refill; Lapsed (90+ days) → send win-back offer; Browsers (never purchased) → send discount.
Open Rate	The percentage of delivered emails that are opened by the recipient. $\text{Open Rate} = (\text{Emails Opened} \div \text{Emails Delivered}) \times 100$. A primary indicator of subject line effectiveness and list health.	e.g. , Wellbeing Nutrition sends 50,000 emails, 12,500 are opened → Open Rate = 25%. Industry average for D2C India is 20–28%.
Click-to-Open Rate (CTOR)	The percentage of people who clicked a link, out of those who opened the email. $\text{CTOR} = \text{Clicks} \div \text{Opens} \times 100$. Measures the quality and relevance of the email body content.	e.g. , 1,000 people open an email, 180 click the CTA button → CTOR = 18%. A high CTOR means the content matched the subject line's promise.
Deliverability	The ability of an email to reach the recipient's inbox (rather than spam or junk folder) — determined by sender reputation, authentication records (SPF, DKIM, DMARC), list hygiene, and content quality.	e.g. , A brand sending to old, unverified addresses gets high bounce rates → Gmail starts routing all their emails to spam → deliverability collapses.
SPF / DKIM / DMARC	Three DNS-based email authentication standards. SPF verifies the sending server is authorised; DKIM adds an encrypted signature to the email; DMARC tells inbox providers how to handle authentication failures.	e.g. , Without SPF + DKIM configured on their domain, Setu's marketing emails get flagged as potential phishing by Gmail.
List Hygiene	The practice of regularly cleaning an email list by removing hard bounces, long-term unengaged subscribers, and invalid addresses — to maintain sender reputation and deliverability.	e.g. , Removing subscribers who haven't opened a single email in 180+ days from OZiva's list — keeping engagement rates high and spam scores low.
Win-Back Campaign	A targeted email sequence sent to subscribers or customers who have not engaged (opened, clicked) or purchased in a defined period (typically 60–90 days) — aimed at re-activating the relationship.	e.g. , A 3-email sequence: Email 1 — 'We miss you + 15% off'; Email 2 — 'Last chance — offer expires in 48 hrs';

		Email 3 — 'Sad to see you go (unsubscribe option)'.
RFM Segmentation	A framework for segmenting customers based on Recency (how recently they purchased), Frequency (how often they buy), and Monetary value (how much they spend) — used to identify top customers and at-risk segments.	e.g., A customer who bought 3 times in the last 60 days, spending ₹5,000+ each time → high RFM score → premium loyalty treatment, not a discount email.

7.1 Types of Marketing Emails

Email Type	Purpose	Example Subject Line
Promotional	Drive immediate purchase or conversion	'Diwali Sale: 40% off ends tonight ☐'
Transactional	Confirm an action taken by the user	'Your order #12345 has been shipped'
Lifecycle / Triggered	Sent based on user behaviour or lifecycle stage	'You've been with us 1 year — here's a gift'
Newsletter	Regular value-add content to maintain engagement	'5 protein myths that are costing you gains'
Re-engagement / Win-Back	Re-activate lapsed customers	'We miss you. Here's 20% off to come back'
B2B Cold Outreach	Initiate a relationship with a prospect	'Quick question about your protein brand's SEO'

7.2 Email Strategy Framework

5 Pillars of High-Performance Email Marketing
▶ List Building — grow subscribers through lead magnets, website popups, post-purchase opt-ins
▶ Segmentation — divide list by: RFM (Recency, Frequency, Monetary), lifecycle stage, product interest
▶ Personalisation — use first name, past purchase data, location, and behaviour triggers
▶ A/B Testing — test one element at a time: subject line, send time, CTA button colour, body copy
▶ List Hygiene — remove unengaged subscribers every 90 days to protect sender reputation

7.3 Email Metrics Dashboard

Metric	Formula	Industry Benchmark
Open Rate	$\text{Emails Opened} \div \text{Emails Delivered} \times 100$	20–30% (e-commerce India)
Click-Through Rate (CTR)	$\text{Clicks} \div \text{Emails Delivered} \times 100$	2–5%
Click-to-Open Rate (CTOR)	$\text{Clicks} \div \text{Emails Opened} \times 100$	10–20% (indicates content relevance)
Bounce Rate	$\text{Bounced} \div \text{Sent} \times 100$	< 2% (> 2% = list hygiene issue)
Unsubscribe Rate	$\text{Unsubscribes} \div \text{Delivered} \times 100$	< 0.5% per send

Spam Complaint Rate	$\text{Complaints} \div \text{Sent} \times 100$	< 0.08% (Google/Yahoo threshold)
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7.4 Email Deliverability — Technical Foundation

Before any email reaches the inbox, it must pass three authentication checks:

Authentication	Purpose	Setup Location
SPF (Sender Policy Framework)	Verifies sending IP is authorised by domain owner	DNS record: TXT record in domain settings
DKIM (DomainKeys Identified Mail)	Adds encrypted signature to prove email wasn't tampered with	DNS record provided by ESP (Mailchimp/HubSpot)
DMARC	Policy that instructs inbox providers what to do with SPF/DKIM failures	DNS TXT record: p=none / quarantine / reject

TOOL TIP	Use Mail-Tester.com before any large send. It gives a deliverability score out of 10 and flags SPF/DKIM issues, spam trigger words, and image-to-text ratio problems.
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References & Further Reading <i>(mapped to tables in this module)</i>			
Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	Email Marketing Rules (3rd ed.)	Chad S. White	CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform, 2017
Book	Email Persuasion	Ian Brodie	Rainmaker Publishing, 2013 — list building & nurture sequences
Website	Mailchimp Email Marketing Benchmarks	Mailchimp / Intuit	mailchimp.com/resources/email-marketing-benchmarks
Website	Really Good Emails — Swipe File	reallygoodemails.com	reallygoodemails.com (inspiration & best-practice templates)
Website	Mail-Tester — Spam Score & Deliverability	mail-tester.com	mail-tester.com (free; no login)
Website	Mailtrap Email Sandbox Documentation	Mailtrap Inc.	mailtrap.io/blog
Course	HubSpot Email Marketing Certification (Free)	HubSpot Academy	academy.hubspot.com/courses/email-marketing
Report	State of Email Report — Litmus	Litmus Software Inc.	litmus.com/resources/state-of-email
Website	Google/Yahoo Bulk Sender Guidelines 2024	Google Workspace	support.google.com/mail/answer/81126
Journal	Journal of Marketing Analytics — RFM & Customer Segmentation Research	Palgrave Macmillan / Springer Nature (active journal)	link.springer.com/journal/41270

MODULE 8

Mobile & WhatsApp Marketing

Sessions 29–30 | AARRR: Retention | Deliverable: DL7

Key Definitions — Learn these before your session

Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Mobile Marketing	Any marketing activity designed primarily for consumption on smartphones or tablets — including push notifications, in-app messaging, SMS, App Store Ads, WhatsApp, and mobile-specific paid campaigns.	e.g. , CleverTap sending Swiggy users a push notification at 12:45 PM daily — timed to when users are most likely to order lunch.
Push Notification	A short message sent directly to a user's device lock screen or notification tray by an app — requiring the user's prior permission. The fastest and highest-visibility mobile retention channel.	e.g. , 'Your Zomato order is 5 minutes away 🍲' — a transactional push notification with near 100% open rate due to immediacy.
In-App Message	A notification or message displayed inside the app while the user is actively using it — used for onboarding tips, feature announcements, promotional offers, or surveys.	e.g. , MeeshoApp showing a full-screen 'Flash Sale starts in 2 hours' banner to a user actively browsing — driving immediate engagement.
ASO (App Store Optimisation)	The process of optimising an app's listing in the App Store (iOS) or Google Play (Android) to improve its discoverability and conversion rate — the mobile equivalent of SEO.	e.g. , CleverTap renaming its app title from 'CleverTap' to 'CleverTap — Mobile Marketing' to capture keyword searches from potential B2B buyers.
D1 / D7 / D30 Retention	The percentage of users who return to an app on Day 1, Day 7, and Day 30 after first install — the industry standard retention framework. Verified industry averages (AppsFlyer, 6 billion installs): D1 ≈ 25%, D7 ≈ 12%, D30 ≈ 5–6% across all app categories. D30 > 10% is exceptional. D1 < 20% signals a critical onboarding problem.	e.g. , A fintech app like Cred: D1 retention 38% (strong onboarding with instant reward activation), D7 retention 15% (good — habit forming), D30 retention 8% (above industry average of 5–6%, indicating genuine utility). Each stage below benchmark triggers a specific fix: poor D1 = fix onboarding; poor D7 = improve notification strategy; poor D30 = deepen core product value.
DAU / MAU Ratio	Daily Active Users divided by Monthly Active Users — a 'stickiness' metric. A ratio > 20% indicates users find the app valuable enough to return frequently.	e.g. , WhatsApp India DAU/MAU ≈ 85% — users open it almost every day. A gaming app at 15% has a stickiness problem.
WhatsApp Business API	The enterprise-grade version of WhatsApp Business that allows brands to send automated, templated messages at scale — including order confirmations, delivery updates, OTPs, and broadcast campaigns — via approved messaging partners.	e.g. , Nykaa sending automated 'Your order has shipped' WhatsApp messages to 50,000 customers daily via the Business API.
Mobile Attribution	The process of identifying which marketing channel or campaign was responsible for an app install or in-app conversion — using an SDK (Software Development Kit) embedded in the app to track the user's journey.	e.g. , AppsFlyer tracking that 40% of Yoga Bar's app installs in October came from Instagram Ads, 30% from Google UAC, 30% organic.
Deep Linking	A mobile technology that routes users from an external link (ad, email, SMS) directly to a specific page within an app — bypassing the homepage and reducing friction to conversion.	e.g. , Clicking a Meesho ad on Instagram opens the app directly on the product page shown in the ad — not the app's homepage.

RFM Segmentation (Mobile)	Applying Recency, Frequency, and Monetary segmentation logic to app users — identifying power users (high RFM), at-risk users (declining recency), and churned users for targeted re-engagement campaigns.	e.g., <i>CleverTap identifying Swiggy users who ordered 4+ times last month but haven't ordered in 12 days → trigger a personalised re-engagement push notification.</i>
Omnichannel Journey	A coordinated sequence of messages across multiple channels (push notification → email → SMS → WhatsApp) designed to reach a user through whichever channel they respond to — if push is ignored, email fires next.	e.g., <i>MoEngage journey for lapsed users: Day 1 push → no open → Day 3 email → no open → Day 5 WhatsApp message → no response → Day 7 SMS.</i>

8.1 India's Mobile-First Context

India is the world's second-largest smartphone market. Key verified statistics (Sources: IDC, EY, IBEF, Statista, 2025):

- Approximately 660 million smartphone users in India — the second-largest smartphone market globally (IDC, 2025).
- India is a mobile-first internet market — fewer than half of Indian internet users access the web via computers; mobile dominates web traffic (DataReportal, 2025).
- WhatsApp has over 500 million active users in India (estimated 500–600 million) — the primary messaging channel for marketing (Statista, 2025).
- Average Indian spends approximately 5 hours/day on a smartphone — nearly 70% devoted to social media, gaming, and video (EY Annual Entertainment Report, March 2025).
- Approximately 80% of all e-commerce transactions in India are completed on mobile devices (Bain/IBEF, 2025).

8.2 App Store Optimisation (ASO)

ASO is the mobile equivalent of SEO — it optimises an app's listing to improve discoverability and conversion in the App Store / Google Play.

ASO Element	Best Practice	Tool
App Title	Include primary keyword in first 30 characters	AppFollow / AppTweak
Short Description (Google Play)	2–3 sentences; keyword-rich; benefit-focused	AppFollow
Long Description	800 chars; keyword variations; social proof; structured	AppFollow + manual
Screenshots	First 2–3 screenshots must communicate core value proposition	Canva (design)
Keywords Field (App Store)	Avoid repetition of title keywords; use less competitive terms	AppTweak
Ratings & Reviews	Respond to all reviews; address negative reviews within 48 hrs	Google Play Console

8.3 Mobile Retention — D1 / D7 / D30 Framework

App retention is measured at Day 1, Day 7, and Day 30 after install. These are the industry benchmark windows:

Metric	Definition	Industry Benchmark (App)
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D1 Retention	% of users who return on Day 1 after install	~25% industry avg; 35%+ is strong; < 20% = onboarding problem
D7 Retention	% who return within 7 days of install	~12% industry avg (Adjust/AppsFlyer); 15%+ is good
D30 Retention	% who return within 30 days of install	~5–6% industry avg; 8–10% is good; 10%+ is exceptional
DAU / MAU Ratio	Daily Active Users ÷ Monthly Active Users	> 20% = high stickiness

8.4 WhatsApp Business Marketing

WhatsApp Business Capabilities	
▶ Business Profile	— verified business name, description, address, website, catalogue
▶ Product Catalogue	— list products with images, prices, and descriptions (up to 500 items)
▶ Quick Replies	— pre-saved responses for FAQs (e.g., 'When will my order arrive?')
▶ Broadcast Lists	— send one message to up to 256 contacts (opted-in)
▶ Labels	— categorise contacts by stage: New Customer / Pending Payment / Order Shipped
▶ WhatsApp Business API	— for scale: automated flows, chatbots, CRM integration (via CleverTap/MoEngage)
▶ Chatbot Flows	— greet → qualify → route → resolve → collect feedback automatically

8.5 Mobile Attribution

Mobile attribution tracks which marketing source drove an app install or in-app conversion.

Tool	What It Does	Key Output
AppsFlyer	Attributes installs to paid/organic sources via SDK	D1/D7/D30 retention by source
Adjust	Alternative to AppsFlyer; strong fraud protection	Cohort analysis, LTV modelling
Google Play Console	Free attribution for Android apps via Play Store campaigns	Install source, store listing visits

References & Further Reading <i>(mapped to tables in this module)</i>			
Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	Mobile Marketing: An Hour a Day	Rachel Pasqua & Noah Elkin	Wiley/Sybex, 2012 — foundational mobile strategy
Book	The WhatsApp Business Guide	WhatsApp Official Docs	business.whatsapp.com/resources
Website	Meta — WhatsApp Business API Documentation	Meta Platforms Inc.	developers.facebook.com/docs/whatsapp
Website	CleverTap Mobile Marketing Academy	CleverTap Inc.	clevertap.com/blog

Website	MoEngage Mobile Marketing Blog	MoEngage Inc.	moengage.com/blog
Report	AppsFlyer State of App Marketing — India 2025	AppsFlyer	appsflyer.com/resources/reports/state-of-app-marketing
Report	TRAI Telecom Subscription Data Report 2025	Telecom Regulatory Authority of India	traai.gov.in/release-publication/reports
Website	Google Play Academy — App Store Listing	Google Play Console Help	play.google.com/console/about/listing-optimisation
Course	CleverTap Engage Course (Free)	CleverTap Academy	clevertap.com/learning-center
Video	HBS Case: InMobi — Reimagining Mobile Ads	Harvard Business School	hbsp.harvard.edu — case code 516030-PDF-ENG

MODULE 9

AI in Digital Marketing

Sessions 31–32 | AARRR: All Stages | Deliverable: DL8

□ Key Definitions — Learn these before your session

Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Generative AI	A class of artificial intelligence that creates new content — text, images, video, audio, code — from a natural language prompt, by learning patterns from large training datasets.	e.g., Asking ChatGPT: 'Write a 150-word Instagram ad for a Vitamin D supplement targeting working professionals in Mumbai' → it produces usable copy in seconds.
Large Language Model (LLM)	The underlying technology behind generative AI tools like ChatGPT, Jasper, and Gemini. An LLM is trained on vast amounts of text data and generates human-like responses to natural language prompts.	e.g., ChatGPT (GPT-4), Google Gemini, and Meta Llama are all LLMs — the engines powering AI writing and content tools.
Prompt Engineering	The skill of crafting precise, detailed natural language instructions (prompts) for an AI model to maximise the quality and relevance of its output — including specifying role, audience, tone, format, and constraints.	e.g., A weak prompt: 'Write an ad.' A strong prompt: 'You are a D2C marketer for a plant protein brand. Write a 100-word Facebook ad using the PAS framework for women aged 25–35 in Tier 1 Indian cities.'
Predictive AI	AI systems that use machine learning on historical data to forecast future outcomes — such as which customers are likely to churn, which leads will convert, or what demand will be next month.	e.g., CleverTap's AI predicting which Meesho app users are likely to lapse in the next 7 days — so the brand can proactively retain them.
Google Performance Max	A single Google Ads campaign type that uses AI to automatically serve ads across all Google channels (Search, Display, YouTube, Gmail, Maps, Shopping, Discover) using provided creative assets and audience signals.	e.g., AS-IT-IS Nutrition providing product images, headline variants, and target audience signals — Google's AI tests all combinations across all channels to maximise conversions.
Meta Advantage+	Meta's AI-powered advertising system (previously called Automated Ads) that automatically selects the best audience, creative combination, budget allocation, and placement across Facebook and Instagram — reducing manual campaign management.	e.g., Pilgrim uploading 10 creative variants to Advantage+ Shopping — Meta's AI runs all combinations and scales budget towards whichever performs best, automatically.
Conversational AI	AI that can understand, process, and respond to natural human language in a back-and-forth dialogue — powering chatbots, virtual assistants, and automated customer service interfaces.	e.g., Nykaa's WhatsApp chatbot answering 'What's the status of my order #NK12345?' with real-time tracking data — no human agent involved.
AI Bias	Systematic errors in AI outputs that reflect and perpetuate historical inequalities or prejudices present in the training data — leading to unfair, inaccurate, or discriminatory outcomes.	e.g., An AI hiring tool trained on historical CVs shows male candidates more frequently for engineering roles — because historical data skewed male. Same risk exists in ad targeting.
Hallucination (AI)	When an AI model generates factually incorrect, plausible-sounding information with apparent confidence — a critical risk when using AI for research, statistics, or claims-based marketing content.	e.g., ChatGPT stating 'Studies show 87% of Indian women are Vitamin D deficient' — a specific statistic it fabricated. Always verify AI-generated facts with primary sources.
AI-Assisted Content	Content created through a human–AI collaboration process where AI generates a first	e.g., A marketer uses Jasper AI to draft a blog post outline and first draft, then

Personalisation at Scale	draft and a human editor refines, fact-checks, and brand-aligns the output — not unedited AI output published directly.	<i>spends 45 minutes editing for brand voice, adding data, and removing inaccuracies before publishing.</i>
	Using AI and automation to deliver individually tailored content, product recommendations, and messages to thousands or millions of customers simultaneously — what previously required manual effort for each individual.	e.g., Amazon India showing different product recommendations to each of its 300 million users based on their unique browsing and purchase history — powered entirely by AI.

9.1 Types of AI in Marketing

AI Type	Definition	Marketing Application
Generative AI	Creates new content (text, image, video) from prompts	Ad copywriting, email subject lines, product descriptions
Predictive AI	Forecasts future outcomes from historical data	Churn prediction, LTV modelling, demand forecasting
Conversational AI	Understands and generates human-like conversation	WhatsApp chatbots, website chat, lead qualification bots
AI-Powered Ads	Automated campaign optimisation using machine learning	Google Performance Max, Meta Advantage+

9.2 Generative AI Tool Stack for Marketers

Tool	Best Use Case	Free Plan?
ChatGPT (GPT-4)	Ad copy, email drafts, persona creation, social captions	Yes (GPT-3.5 free; GPT-4o partially free)
Jasper AI	Long-form marketing content: blog posts, whitepapers, case studies	7-day trial
Canva AI (Magic Write)	Social media captions + carousel copy inside Canva	Free credits
Copy.ai	Product descriptions, CTAs, landing page copy in seconds	2,000 words/month free
Perplexity AI	Research with cited sources — fact-checking, market insights	Free with limits
Google Performance Max	AI-powered ad campaign across all Google channels automatically	Available in Google Ads

9.3 Prompting Framework — SCRIBE

A good AI prompt follows the SCRIBE framework to get high-quality, brand-consistent output:

Element	Meaning	Example
S — Situation	Set the context and role	'You are a performance marketer at a D2C skincare brand in India...'

C — Customer	Define the audience	'...targeting 25–35 year old urban women...'
R — Result	State the output you want	'...write a 150-word Meta ad copy...'
I — Instructions	Give specific constraints	'...use PAS framework (Problem-Agitate-Solution), end with a CTA'
B — Brand Voice	Define tone and style	'...tone: confident, scientific, not preachy; avoid jargon'
E — Examples	Show a reference	'...similar to: [paste an ad copy example]'

9.4 AI in Advertising — Performance Max & Advantage+

Google Performance Max

- ▶ Single campaign type that serves ads across Search, Display, YouTube, Gmail, Maps, and Discover
- ▶ Requires: asset groups (headlines, descriptions, images, videos) + audience signals
- ▶ AI determines the best combination and channel for each user in real time
- ▶ Best for: brands with conversion data and clear goals; poor for brand control / niche targeting
- ▶ Key metric: Conversion Value / Cost (ROAS) at campaign level

Meta Advantage+ (Andromeda AI)

- ▶ Automates audience selection — Meta's AI finds the best audience based on creative performance
- ▶ Automated creative combinations — tests all headline + image + CTA combinations automatically
- ▶ Advantage+ Shopping Campaigns — for D2C e-commerce; AI handles budget, bidding, and targeting
- ▶ Risk: less manual control; brand safety must be managed through creative guidelines
- ▶ Case: Meta (HBS 526031) shows how Andromeda shifted campaign management to AI-first approach

9.5 AI Ethics in Marketing

Ethical Issue	Risk	Mitigation
AI Bias	Training data reflects historical inequalities; ads may unfairly exclude groups	Audit audience data; test for demographic disparities in ad delivery
Data Privacy	AI models trained on personal data without explicit consent	GDPR / PDPB India compliance; privacy-first data collection
Transparency	Users may not know they're interacting with AI-generated content	Disclose AI use in ads and chatbot interactions
Over-Automation	Removing human judgment from sensitive creative decisions	Keep human review for brand-critical and sensitive content

References & Further Reading *(mapped to tables in this module)*

Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
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Report	Salesforce State of Marketing Report 2025	Salesforce Inc.	salesforce.com/resources/research-reports/state-of-marketing
Report	McKinsey — Economic Potential of Generative AI	McKinsey Global Institute	mckinsey.com/capabilities/mckinsey-digital/our-insights
Website	OpenAI — ChatGPT for Business Use Cases	OpenAI	openai.com/chatgpt/use-cases
Website	Google Performance Max Best Practices	Google Ads Help	support.google.com/google-ads/answer/10724750
Website	Meta Advantage+ Campaigns Guide	Meta Business Help Centre	facebook.com/business/help/advantage-plus-shopping-campaigns
Course	Jasper AI Bootcamp for Marketers (Free Trial)	Jasper AI	jasper.ai/academy
Journal	Generative AI in Marketing: Ethics & Practice	Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science	link.springer.com/journal/11747
Website	HubSpot — How to Use AI in Marketing (Guide)	HubSpot Inc.	blog.hubspot.com/marketing/how-to-use-ai-in-marketing
Video	HBS Case: Meta — Digital Marketing & AI (526031)	Harvard Business School	hbsp.harvard.edu — case code 526031-PDF-ENG
Report	India AI Readiness Index — NASSCOM 2025	NASSCOM	nasscom.in/knowledge-center/reports

MODULE 10

Personal Branding & Digital Portfolio

Session 33 | Career Readiness | Final Presentation

Key Definitions — Learn these before your session

Term	Definition	Real-World Example (India)
Personal Brand	The deliberate, consistent impression you create in the minds of professional contacts — through your LinkedIn presence, published content, certifications, portfolio, and the way you communicate your expertise and values.	e.g., An MBA student who consistently posts LinkedIn insights about D2C marketing trends, has 3 certifications, and a Notion portfolio of 8 live campaigns — that is a personal brand.
LinkedIn SSI Score	Social Selling Index — LinkedIn's 0–100 score measuring four equally weighted pillars (25 pts each): establishing your professional brand, finding the right people, engaging with insights, and building relationships. LinkedIn's official data shows high-SSI professionals create 45% more opportunities and are 51% more likely to hit quota. Average SSI is 40–50; above 60 is above average; 70+ is good.	e.g., A student with a complete, keyword-rich profile (Pillar 1: 22/25), who uses LinkedIn search filters to connect with recruiters (Pillar 2: 18/25), engages with industry posts daily (Pillar 3: 20/25), and sends personalised connection requests (Pillar 4: 19/25) scores SSI ≈ 79 — well above the 40–50 average and highly visible to recruiters.
Digital Portfolio	A publicly accessible collection of your actual work — campaign briefs, analytics dashboards, ad copies, Canva designs, SEO audits — that proves tool proficiency and strategic thinking beyond what a CV can communicate.	e.g., A Notion site built during the DM course containing DL1 keyword audit, DL2 Meta campaign blueprint, DL3 Looker Studio dashboard, and DL5 influencer brief with screenshots.
Case Study (Portfolio)	A structured, narrative account of a marketing project — covering the business problem, research process, strategy chosen, tools used, execution, and projected/actual results. The most persuasive portfolio format for DM roles.	e.g., A 500-word case study: 'How I identified a whitespace opportunity in the sleep supplement category using SEMrush + Facebook Ads Library — and built a full-funnel strategy to capture it.'
Certification (Digital Marketing)	A credentials issued by a platform or institution upon passing an assessment, validating proficiency in a specific tool or discipline. Free industry certifications from Google, HubSpot, and Meta are recognised by recruiters as practical skill indicators.	e.g., Google Analytics 4 Certification on a student's LinkedIn profile signals to MakeMyTrip's hiring team that the candidate can work in GA4 from Day 1.
Thought Leadership Content	Original professional content — LinkedIn posts, articles, short videos — that shares genuine insights, analyses, or perspectives on industry trends, demonstrating expertise and building professional credibility over time.	e.g., An MBA student posting: '3 things Minimalist does better than competitors in their SEO strategy — and what D2C brands can learn from it.' — 150 words, original observation, screenshot of SEMrush data.
Recruiter Keyword Optimisation	Strategically placing industry-relevant keywords (tools, skills, role titles) in your LinkedIn headline, About section, and Experience descriptions — so LinkedIn's search algorithm surfaces your profile in recruiter searches.	e.g., Including 'SEO', 'Google Ads', 'GA4', 'Meta Ads Manager', 'HubSpot', 'performance marketing' in your LinkedIn headline and About section increases discoverability significantly.
Portfolio-Based Interview	A hiring process where the candidate is evaluated based on real work they have produced — campaign screenshots, analytics reports, ad copies — rather than hypothetical answers to interview questions.	e.g., Swiggy's DM Executive interview: 'Walk us through a paid campaign you set up — show me the campaign structure, targeting, and the metrics you tracked.' — your DL2 deliverable answers this live.

Professional Network (LinkedIn)	The aggregate of connections, followers, and communities a professional maintains on LinkedIn — a primary channel for discovering job opportunities, getting referrals, and building industry relationships before placements.	e.g., An MBA student with 500+ relevant connections (DM professionals, recruiters, alumni at target companies) hears about unadvertised roles through network posts.
AI for Personal Branding	The use of generative AI tools to accelerate the production of thought leadership content — including drafting LinkedIn posts, structuring case studies, and creating visual assets — while maintaining authentic human voice and perspective.	e.g., Using ChatGPT to draft a LinkedIn post outline from a campaign insight, then editing it to add personal voice, specific data, and a genuine opinion before publishing.

10.1 Why Personal Branding Matters for DM Professionals

Digital marketing is a discipline where practitioners are expected to demonstrate what they preach. Recruiters at Ogilvy, iProspect, Swiggy, and Razorpay evaluate candidates' LinkedIn profiles before interviews. A strong personal brand is a direct signal of competence.

Personal Brand Element	Why It Matters	Action Required
LinkedIn Profile	First touchpoint for 90%+ of recruiters	Optimise headline, About, and Featured section with DM keywords
SSI Score (LinkedIn)	Measures social selling effectiveness (0–100); LinkedIn data: high SSI → 45% more opportunities	Target SSI > 70 before placements (average is 40–50)
Content Calendar	Thought leadership posts signal expertise publicly	Post 2–3 times per week during placement season
Digital Portfolio	Proof of tool proficiency and campaign thinking	Build Notion site with DL0–DL8 case studies
Certifications	Resume differentiator; validates skill claims	Minimum 2 free certifications required (Google, HubSpot, Meta)

10.2 LinkedIn Profile Optimisation Framework

LinkedIn SSI — The 4 Pillars
▶ Pillar 1: Establish Your Professional Brand — complete profile, professional photo, keyword-rich headline and About section
▶ Pillar 2: Find the Right People — connect with recruiters, DM professionals, faculty, and alumni using advanced search
▶ Pillar 3: Engage with Insights — like, comment, share relevant industry content; post original perspectives
▶ Pillar 4: Build Relationships — send personalised InMails; follow up on connections; join DM-related LinkedIn groups

10.3 Building a DM Portfolio on Notion

Your Notion portfolio serves as a public-facing case study repository. Structure each deliverable as a case study:

Case Study Section	Content to Include
Problem Statement	What business challenge were you solving? Which product/brand?
Research & Data	Key findings from DL0 (Opportunity Scoring Matrix, Pain Point Bank)
Strategy	The approach taken — which channels, frameworks, and rationale
Execution	Screenshots of tools used (SEMrush, GA4, Mailchimp, Canva, HubSpot)
Results / Projections	Expected KPIs, benchmarks, or projected outcomes
Reflection	What you'd do differently; what AI helped with; key learning

10.4 Certification Roadmap — All Free

Minimum 2 Required Recommended: All 6
▶ Google Ads Search Certification (Google Skillshop) — feeds DL2 ~3–5 hours
▶ Google Analytics 4 Certification (Google Skillshop) — feeds DL3 ~4–6 hours
▶ HubSpot Inbound Marketing Certification (HubSpot Academy) — feeds DL4 ~4 hours
▶ Meta Blueprint Certification (Meta) — feeds DL2 & DL5 ~4–6 hours
▶ SEMrush SEO Toolkit Exam (SEMrush Academy) — feeds DL0 & DL1 ~2–3 hours
▶ LinkedIn Marketing Labs Certification (LinkedIn) — feeds DL5 ~3 hours

□ References & Further Reading <i>(mapped to tables in this module)</i>			
Type	Title / Resource	Source / Author	Access / URL
Book	Crush It! — Why Now Is the Time to Cash In on Your Passion	Gary Vaynerchuk	HarperBusiness, 2009 — personal brand building for professionals
Book	Known: The Handbook for Building and Unleashing Your Personal Brand	Mark Schaefer	Schaefer Marketing Solutions, 2017
Website	LinkedIn SSI Score & Social Selling Index Guide	LinkedIn Corporation	linkedin.com/sales/ssi
Website	Shield App — LinkedIn Analytics for Creators	Shield Analytics	shieldapp.ai
Website	Notion — Free Portfolio Site Templates	Notion Labs Inc.	notion.so/templates — search 'portfolio'
Website	Google Skillshop — All Free Certifications Hub	Google LLC	skillshop.withgoogle.com
Course	Get a Job in Digital Marketing (includes LinkedIn & personal branding)	SEMrush Academy	semrush.com/academy/courses/get-a-job-in-digital-marketing-with-no-experience
Report	LinkedIn Talent Trends: How Recruiters Use LinkedIn	LinkedIn Talent Solutions	business.linkedin.com/talent-solutions/resources/talent-acquisition
Website	HubSpot — Personal Branding for Marketers Guide	HubSpot Inc.	blog.hubspot.com/marketing/personal-brand

Website	Canva — Free LinkedIn Banner & Portfolio Templates	<i>Canva Pty Ltd.</i>	canva.com/create/linkedin-banner
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MASTER GLOSSARY

Key Terms — Digital Marketing Course

Term	Definition
AARRR	Acquisition, Activation, Retention, Revenue, Referral — the five-stage growth funnel framework
ACoS	Advertising Cost of Sale — $\text{Ad Spend} \div \text{Ad Revenue} \times 100$. Used for Amazon Ads.
ASO	App Store Optimisation — improving app discoverability in the App Store or Google Play
ASCI	Advertising Standards Council of India — regulates influencer disclosure requirements
Attribution	Assigning conversion credit to marketing touchpoints along the buyer journey
BOFU	Bottom of Funnel — decision stage; content = case studies, demos, ROI calculators
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost — $\text{total marketing spend} \div \text{new customers acquired}$
CLV / LTV	Customer Lifetime Value — total revenue expected from a customer over their lifetime
Content Cluster	Group of SEO content: one Pillar Page + supporting Cluster Articles linked together
Core Web Vitals	Google's three current page experience ranking metrics: LCP ($\leq 2.5s$), INP ($\leq 200ms$, replaced FID in March 2024), and CLS (< 0.1)
CPA	Cost Per Acquisition — $\text{total ad spend} \div \text{number of conversions}$
CPC	Cost Per Click — $\text{ad spend} \div \text{number of clicks}$
CPM	Cost Per Mille — cost per 1,000 ad impressions
CRO	Conversion Rate Optimisation — increasing the % of visitors who complete a desired action
CTR	Click-Through Rate — $\text{clicks} \div \text{impressions} \times 100$
D1/D7/D30	Day 1, Day 7, Day 30 retention rates — standard mobile app benchmarks
DKIM	DomainKeys Identified Mail — email authentication standard
DMARC	Domain-based Message Authentication — email policy for handling SPF/DKIM failures
DSP	Demand-Side Platform — allows advertisers to buy digital ad inventory programmatically
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness — Google's quality signals
EMV	Earned Media Value — monetary equivalent of organic/influencer reach
Engagement Rate	$(\text{Likes} + \text{Comments}) \div \text{Followers} \times 100$
GA4	Google Analytics 4 — event-based web and app analytics platform
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation — EU data privacy law affecting email marketing
KD	Keyword Difficulty — SEMrush score (0–100) indicating how hard a keyword is to rank for
Lead Magnet	Free value-exchange asset (e-book, checklist) offered to capture email addresses
LTV:CAC	Ratio of customer lifetime value to acquisition cost; $\geq 3:1$ is considered healthy

Lookalike Audience	Meta/Google audience of users similar to your existing customers
MQL	Marketing Qualified Lead — lead deemed ready for further marketing engagement
MOFU	Middle of Funnel — consideration stage; content = guides, webinars, comparisons
NSM	North Star Metric — single most important metric that captures core business value
Performance Max	Google Ads campaign type using AI to serve ads across all Google properties
Pillar Page	Comprehensive long-form page covering a broad topic; links to all cluster articles
ROAS	Return on Ad Spend — revenue generated ÷ ad spend
RFM	Recency, Frequency, Monetary — framework for segmenting email/CRM lists
RLSA	Remarketing Lists for Search Ads — Google feature targeting past visitors in search
RTB	Real-Time Bidding — automated auction for digital ad impressions in milliseconds
SQL	Sales Qualified Lead — lead deemed ready for a sales conversation
SPF	Sender Policy Framework — email authentication verifying sending IP is authorised
SSI	Social Selling Index — LinkedIn score (0–100) measuring personal brand effectiveness
SSP	Supply-Side Platform — allows publishers to sell ad inventory programmatically
TOFU	Top of Funnel — awareness stage; content = blogs, Reels, infographics
UTM	Urchin Tracking Module — URL parameters used to track campaign traffic in GA4
UGC	User-Generated Content — organic content created by customers about a brand

ASSESSMENT QUICK REFERENCE

Weightage, Timelines & Deliverable Guide

Component	Timing	Weight	Key Focus
Test I — MCQ (Modules 1–3)	Session 13	15%	AARRR, SEO pillars, Google Ads structure, performance metrics
Test II — MCQ (Modules 4–6)	Session 26	15%	GA4, UTMs, CRO, inbound funnel, influencer tiers, social audit
DL0 — NPD Opportunity Report	Pre-Session 3	10%	5-step opportunity process, scoring matrix ≥ 10/15, Hero Product
DL1 — SEO & Demand Validation	Post Session 7	10%	50+ keywords, content cluster, competitor audit with screenshots
DL2 — Paid Media Blueprint	Post Session 12	10%	Campaign architecture, 3 ad copies, budget table, audience brief
DL3 — Analytics & Landing Page	Post Session 18	10%	KPI framework, UTM plan, GA4 events, CRO wireframe, Looker Studio
DL4 — Content Strategy & Automation	Post Session 21	10%	Buyer personas, 30-day calendar, lead magnet, Mailchimp sequence
DL5 — Organic Social & Influencer	Post Session 25	10%	Competitor audit, Canva posts, influencer brief, ASCI check
DL6 — Email Retention Sequences	Post Session 28	10%	5-email post-purchase flow, win-back series, Mail-Tester report
DL7 — Mobile & WhatsApp Plan	Post Session 30	10%	ASO audit, push notifications, WhatsApp journey, attribution plan
DL8 — AI Creative Sprint	Post Session 32	10%	9 ad copies with prompts, Canva carousel, AI reflection
Certification Portfolio (min 2)	End of course	5% (bonus)	Google Ads, GA4, HubSpot Inbound, Meta Blueprint, SEMrush SEO
Final Presentation	Post Session 33	10%	DL0→DL8 integrated campaign pitch; 20 min + 10 min Q&A
Comprehensive Exam	End semester	25%	Full conceptual mastery across all 10 modules

CRITICAL RULE

Every deliverable requires screenshots proving tool usage. Submissions without tool screenshots will not be marked. Always capture your work as you complete it.

HBS Cases — At a Glance

Session	Case Title	Key Learning
S8–12	Gupta Media: Performance Marketing in the Digital Age (520031)	CAC, ROAS, budget allocation across Facebook and Google

S8–12	Digital Marketing at HBS Online (521027)	Channel strategy, attribution modelling, \$60M budget decisions
S14–18	Hubble Contact Lenses: Data Driven D2C Marketing (519011)	LTV:CAC trade-offs, multi-channel attribution, D2C analytics
S19–21	HubSpot: Inbound Marketing and Web 2.0 (509049)	Inbound vs outbound, MQL/SQL lifecycle, marketing automation
S22–25	The Meteoric Rise of Skims (524023)	Social-first DTC brand, influencer seeding, UGC strategy
S29–30	InMobi: Reimagining Mobile Advertising (516030)	Mobile programmatic, emerging market digital strategy
S31–32	Meta: Digital Marketing and AI at Facebook and Instagram (526031)	Advantage+ AI campaigns, automated targeting and creative optimisation

CONSOLIDATED BIBLIOGRAPHY

Complete Reading & Resource List

All resources listed below are referenced in the module-level tables throughout this diary.

I. Core Textbooks — Recommended for Purchase or Library Access

★ **Primary Text (Prescribed):** Dwesar, R., & Kesharwani, A. (2025). *Digital marketing: Tools, techniques, and trends*. Wiley. ISBN 9370607382

#	Title (APA format)	Author(s)	Publisher / Year	Modules
★ 1 PRIMARY	Dwesar, R., & Kesharwani, A. (2025). <i>Digital marketing: Tools, techniques, and trends</i> . Wiley. ISBN 9370607382	Rishi Dwesar & Ankit Kesharwani	Wiley, 2025 — 680 pp.	ALL modules — Prescribed Text
2	Chaffey, D., & Ellis-Chadwick, F. (2022). <i>Digital marketing</i> (7th ed.). Pearson.	Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick	Pearson, 2022	1, 2, 3, 4, 5
3	Kotler, P., Keller, K. L., & Chernev, A. (2022). <i>Marketing management</i> (16th ed.). Pearson.	Kotler, Keller & Chernev	Pearson, 2022	1, 5
4	Enge, E., Spencer, S., & Stricchiola, J. (2023). <i>The art of SEO</i> (4th ed.). O'Reilly.	Enge, Spencer & Stricchiola	O'Reilly, 2023	2
5	Clarke, A. (2025). <i>SEO 2025</i> . Simple Effectiveness Publishing.	Adam Clarke	Simple Effectiveness Publishing, 2025	2
6	Marshall, P., Rhodes, M., & Todd, B. (2020). <i>Ultimate guide to Google ads</i> (6th ed.). Entrepreneur Press.	Marshall, Rhodes & Todd	Entrepreneur Press, 2020	3

7	Marshall, P., Regnerus, B., & Meloche, T. (2020). Ultimate guide to Facebook advertising (4th ed.). Entrepreneur Press.	Marshall, Regnerus & Meloche	Entrepreneur Press, 2020	3
8	Kaushik, A. (2010). Web analytics 2.0. Sybex.	Avinash Kaushik	Sybex, 2010	4
9	Goward, C. (2013). You should test that! Sybex.	Chris Goward	Sybex, 2013	4
10	Halligan, B., & Shah, D. (2014). Inbound marketing (Rev. ed.). Wiley.	Halligan & Shah	Wiley, 2014	5
11	Sheridan, M. (2019). They ask, you answer. Wiley.	Marcus Sheridan	Wiley, 2019	5
12	Pulizzi, J. (2021). Content inc. (2nd ed.). McGraw-Hill.	Joe Pulizzi	McGraw-Hill, 2021	5
13	Schaffer, N. (2020). The age of influence. HarperCollins Leadership.	Neal Schaffer	HarperCollins Leadership, 2020	6
14	Vaynerchuk, G. (2013). Jab, jab, jab, right hook. HarperBusiness.	Gary Vaynerchuk	HarperBusiness, 2013	6
15	White, C. S. (2017). Email marketing rules (3rd ed.). CreateSpace Independent Publishing.	Chad S. White	CreateSpace, 2017	7
16	Pasqua, R., & Elkin, N. (2012). Mobile marketing: An hour a day. Wiley/Sybex.	Rachel Pasqua & Noah Elkin	Wiley/Sybex, 2012	8
17	Schaefer, M. (2017). Known: The handbook for building and unleashing your personal brand. Schaefer Marketing Solutions.	Mark Schaefer	Schaefer Marketing Solutions, 2017	10
18	Vaynerchuk, G. (2009). Crush it! HarperBusiness.	Gary Vaynerchuk	HarperBusiness, 2009	10

II. Free Online Platforms & Learning Resources

Platform	What It Offers	Best For (Module)	URL
Google Skillshop	Free certifications: Google Ads, GA4, Display, Video	Modules 2, 3, 4	skillshop.withgoogle.com
HubSpot Academy	Free certs: Inbound, Email, CRM, Content, Social	Modules 5, 7	academy.hubspot.com
Meta Blueprint	Free courses & certifications in Meta Ads	Modules 3, 6	facebook.com/business/learn
SEMrush Academy	Free SEO, PPC, Content, Social Media courses & exams	Modules 2, 3, 6	semrush.com/academy

LinkedIn Marketing Labs	Free LinkedIn Ads & B2B marketing certification	Modules 6, 10	linkedin.com/learning/topics/marketing
Google Digital Garage	Fundamentals of Digital Marketing (26 modules, free)	Module 1	learndigital.withgoogle.com
CleverTap Academy	Mobile marketing & lifecycle management courses	Module 8	clevertap.com/learning-center
Moz Academy	SEO fundamentals and advanced courses	Module 2	moz.com/learn/seo
Coursera — Meta Marketing	Social Media Marketing Specialisation (audit free)	Modules 3, 6	coursera.org/specializations/social-media-marketing
CXL Institute	Advanced CRO, experimentation & growth marketing blog	Module 4	cxl.com/blog
Backlinko	In-depth SEO guides and Google ranking factor studies	Module 2	backlinko.com
Ahrefs Blog	SEO tutorials, keyword research, backlink strategy	Module 2	ahrefs.com/blog
WordStream PPC Blog	Google Ads and PPC benchmarks and tutorials	Module 3	wordstream.com/blog

III. Key Industry Reports — Annual Reading

Report Title	Publisher	Frequency	URL / Where to Find
Digital 2025 India Report	DataReportal / We Are Social	Annual (Jan)	datareportal.com/reports/digital-2025-india
State of Marketing Report	HubSpot Inc.	Annual	hubspot.com/state-of-marketing
State of Email Report	Litmus Software	Annual	litmus.com/resources/state-of-email
Hootsuite Social Trends Report	Hootsuite Inc.	Annual (Jan)	hootsuite.com/research/social-trends
Sprout Social Index	Sprout Social Inc.	Annual	sproutsocial.com/insights/data/social-index
State of App Marketing — India	AppsFlyer	Annual	appsflyer.com/resources/reports
McKinsey — Generative AI Economic Potential	McKinsey Global Institute	Periodic	mckinsey.com/capabilities/mckinsey-digital
India Influencer Marketing Report	Influencer.in / Klear	Annual	influencer.in/resources/reports
Salesforce State of Marketing	Salesforce Inc.	Biannual	salesforce.com/resources/research-reports/state-of-marketing

NASSCOM AI Readiness Index — India	NASSCOM	Annual	nasscom.in/knowledge-center/reports
TRAI Telecom Subscription Data	Telecom Regulatory Authority of India	Monthly	trai.gov.in/release-publication/reports
Google / Kantar — India Consumer Insights	Think with Google	Ongoing	thinkwithgoogle.com/intl/en-apac/tools-resources/research-studies

IV. Harvard Business School Cases — Required for Class Discussion

Case Code	Case Title	Authors	Year	Key Learning Objective
520031-PDF-ENG	Gupta Media: Performance Marketing in the Digital Age (A)+(B)	Rangan & Han	2019 / Rev. 2023	CAC, ROAS, data-driven budget allocation across Facebook & Google
521027-PDF-ENG	Digital Marketing at HBS Online	Gupta & Lal	2020	Channel strategy, attribution modelling, \$60M digital budget decisions
519011-PDF-ENG	Hubble Contact Lenses: Data Driven D2C Marketing	Avery & Israeli	2018 / Rev. 2023	LTV:CAC trade-offs, multi-channel attribution, D2C performance measurement
509049-PDF-ENG	HubSpot: Inbound Marketing and Web 2.0	Steenburgh, Avery & Dahod	2009 / Rev. 2011	Inbound vs outbound marketing, MQL/SQL lifecycle, pricing strategy
524023-PDF-ENG	The Meteoric Rise of Skims	Israeli, Avery & Schlesinger	Sep 2023	Social-first DTC brand building, influencer seeding, UGC at \$4B valuation
516030-PDF-ENG	InMobi: Reimagining Mobile Advertising	Gupta & Chaturvedi	Apr 2016	Mobile programmatic advertising, emerging market digital strategy
526031-PDF-ENG	Meta: Digital Marketing and AI at Facebook and Instagram	Dolan, Avery & Chammas	Oct 2025	AI-powered advertising, Andromeda algorithm, automated targeting & creative

HOW TO ACCESS HBS CASES

All 7 cases are available at hbsp.harvard.edu. Individual access costs approximately \$4–\$8 per case. Your faculty will share a course adoption link — purchase through that link to ensure correct version. Cases should be read in full before the assigned session.

V. Indian D2C Brand References — For Project Benchmarking

Category	Benchmark Brands	What to Study	Where to Observe
Health & Wellness	OZiva, Wellbeing Nutrition, Kapiva, Setu	SEO content clusters, influencer strategy, email onboarding flows	Their website, Instagram, and Amazon listings

Beauty & Skincare	Minimalist, Pilgrim, mCaffeine, Mamaearth	Product page SEO, UGC strategy, Meta ad creatives, Google Shopping	Facebook Ads Library, Google searches, Instagram Reels
Fitness Nutrition	MuscleBlaze, AS-IT-IS Nutrition, Steadfast	Keyword strategy, YouTube content, loyalty email flows	SEMrush domain audit + Amazon product reviews
Food & Nutrition	True Elements, Yoga Bar, The Whole Truth	Content marketing, D2C subscription model, WhatsApp CRM	Their blog, newsletters (subscribe), WhatsApp channel
Personal Care	Carmesi, PeeSafe, Sirona, Ustraa	Influencer tiers, ASCI compliance examples, social audit	Instagram profiles, Klear / PhlanxIO engagement checks
Mental Wellness	Misters, Woke & Chill, Happier	Content strategy for sensitive categories, inbound SEO	Website content, AnswerThePublic keyword mapping
Food Delivery / Super-Apps	Swiggy, Zomato, Meesho, Nykaa	Push notification copy, app store listings, paid media structure	App Store / Play Store listings, Facebook Ads Library

VI. Essential Tool Documentation — Quick Reference URLs

Tool	Type	Documentation URL	Free Plan?
Google Ads	Paid Search / Display / Video	support.google.com/google-ads	Yes (no spend required for setup)
Meta Ads Manager	Social Advertising	facebook.com/business/help/200000840044554	Yes (spend required to run ads)
Google Analytics 4	Web & App Analytics	support.google.com/analytics	Yes — free forever
Google Looker Studio	Data Visualisation / Dashboards	support.google.com/looker-studio	Yes — free forever
SEMrush	SEO & Competitive Intelligence	semrush.com/kb	Freemium (10 queries/day free)
Screaming Frog SEO Spider	Technical SEO Crawler	screamingfrog.co.uk/seo-spider/user-guide	Free up to 500 URLs
Google Search Console	SEO Performance Data	support.google.com/webmasters	Yes — free forever
HubSpot CRM	CRM & Marketing Automation	knowledge.hubspot.com	Yes — free CRM tier
Mailchimp	Email Marketing	mailchimp.com/resources/mailchimp-101	Yes — 500 contacts / 1,000 sends

Microsoft Clarity	Heatmaps & Session Recording	clarity.microsoft.com/docs	Yes — free & unlimited
CleverTap	Mobile Marketing Automation	docs.clevertap.com	Startup free tier (request)
MoEngage	Omnichannel Customer Engagement	docs.moengage.com	Free demo on request
WhatsApp Business App	Mobile CRM & Broadcasting	business.whatsapp.com/resources	Yes — free app
AppsFlyer	Mobile Attribution	support.appsflyer.com	Free demo account
Hootsuite	Social Media Management	help.hootsuite.com	30-day free trial
Canva	Design & AI Content Creation	help.canva.com	Yes — Canva Free; Education = Pro free
Buffer	Social Media Scheduling	support.buffer.com	Yes — 3 channels, 10 posts each
Google Keyword Planner	Keyword Research & CPC Data	support.google.com/google-ads/answer/7337243	Yes (needs Google Ads account)
Amazon Advertising Console	E-commerce Retail Media	advertising.amazon.com/resources/help	Yes (spend required to run ads)
LinkedIn Campaign Manager	B2B Advertising	linkedin.com/help/lms	Yes (spend required to run ads)

Students who treat the project as a live client assignment — not an academic exercise — consistently produce stronger campaigns and stronger interviews.

— Course Handout, IBS Hyderabad